

Essay Writing for CSS Aspirants

A 17-session grammar foundation: from the sentence to a timed mini-essay. Notes for the classroom teacher and the candidate.

British English · 17 × 90-minute sessions

Parts of speech · Tenses · Voice · Narration · Error removal · Paragraph and essay transfer

01–05

THE SENTENCE & PARTS
OF SPEECH

06–11

TENSE, AGREEMENT,
VOICE, NARRATION

12–17

ERRORS, STYLE, TIMED
WRITING

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Part A — Course design

Syllabus, method, formula sheet, and how to photocopy the pack.

CSS Essay Writing — Grammar Foundation Syllabus

Course title: From Sentence to Essay: Grammar for CSS Aspirants

Duration: 17 sessions (90 minutes each)

Exam target: CSS Compulsory English Essay (100) and language accuracy for Precis & Composition (100)

Language standard: British English

Users: Classroom teacher + CSS student

1. Why this course exists

FPSC's own essay instruction is short:

Candidates will be required to write one or more Essay in English. A wide choice of topics will be given. Candidates are expected to reflect comprehensive and research based knowledge on a selected topic. Candidate's articulation, expression and technical treatment of the style of Essay writing will be examined.

Examiner reports keep repeating the same failures:

- incorrect and flawed language
- broken sentence structure
- tense mixing
- weak vocabulary or showy vocabulary used wrongly
- no logical organisation
- no cohesion between paragraphs
- Urdu thought translated word for word

A CSS essay is failed by **grammar before it is failed by ideas**. This syllabus therefore spends 17 sessions on the fundamentals the teacher already uses in class — parts of speech, tenses, voice, narration, and error removal — and forces every rule into essay writing.

2. Course aims

By the end of Session 17, the student will be able to:

1. Identify every word in a sentence by its **part of speech** and repair the sentence from that diagnosis.
2. Control the **12 tense forms** and keep one time-frame inside a paragraph.
3. Write **active and passive** sentences on purpose, not by accident.

4. Convert **direct speech to narration** when quoting reports, leaders, or thinkers.
5. Spot and correct the error families FPSC recycles: agreement, articles, prepositions, tense, conditionals, parallelism, modifiers, diction.
6. Remove **Pakistani/Urdu interference** (discuss about, I am agree, unless you don't, one of the reason).
7. Build a **grammar-clean paragraph** with a topic sentence, evidence, and a link.
8. Produce a **timed mini-essay** (250–300 words) that would not be dismissed for language.

3. Design principles (for the teacher)

Principle	Classroom meaning
Rule → Example → Essay transfer	Never teach a rule without a CSS-topic sentence
Diagnose, don't decorate	Students name the error before they rewrite
Smallest correct change	Same FPSC instruction as sentence correction
British usage	<i>organisation, programme, towards, practise (v)</i>
Urdu contrast	Every session has a "don't translate this" box
Two audiences	Left side of each session is teacher timing; the notes are student-ready
Recycle errors	Old mistakes return in later drills

4. Module map

Module	Ses-sions	Engine	Essay payoff
A. The sentence and parts of speech	1–5	What each word is doing	Accurate diction, articles, prepositions, connectors
B. Tense, agreement, voice, narration	6–11	Time and responsibility in the sentence	Historical evidence, policy argument, quotations
C. Errors, style, timed essay	12–17	Hunting mistakes and writing under the clock	Examiner-safe language in a real essay shape

5. Session list (the 17 classes)

Module A — Foundation

No.	Title	Core grammar	CSS essay use
1	The CSS sentence and the examiner's demand	Sentence vs fragment vs run-on; subject + predicate; four sentence types	Why language marks kill an otherwise informed essay
2	Parts of speech I — nouns, pronouns, articles	Countable/uncountable; one of the + plural; a/an/the/zero	<i>the state, governance, information, a policy</i>

No.	Title	Core grammar	CSS essay use
3	Parts of speech II — verbs, auxiliaries, modals	Finite verbs; do/be/have; can/could/may/must/should/would	Hedging and force in argument (<i>must, should, would</i>)
4	Parts of speech III — adjectives, adverbs, determiners	Order of adjectives; comparison; much/many/few/little	Precise evaluation without empty intensifiers
5	Parts of speech IV — prepositions, conjunctions, connectors	in/on/at/of/to; although/but; cohesion devices	Paragraph glue: <i>however, therefore, in contrast</i>

Module B — Time, voice, narration

No.	Title	Core grammar	CSS essay use
6	Tenses I — the present system	Simple, continuous, perfect, perfect continuous	Universal claims, current affairs, ongoing crises
7	Tenses II — the past system	Simple, continuous, perfect, used to	History, case studies, “Pakistan in 1971 / 1998 / 2010”
8	Tenses III — future, mixed tenses, sequence	will/going to/present for future; sequence of tenses	Policy recommendations and consistent paragraphs
9	Agreement and sentence architecture	SVA; neither/nor; many a; collective nouns	Long CSS sentences that still agree
10	Active and passive voice	Form, by-agent, when passive is better	<i>The bill was passed vs Parliament passed the bill</i>
11	Narration — direct and indirect speech	Backshift; questions; commands; reporting verbs	Quoting a report, a leader, or a thinker without breaking tense

Module C — Accuracy and transfer

No.	Title	Core grammar	CSS essay use
12	Conditionals and hypothetical policy	0, 1, 2, 3, mixed; unless/until; wish/as if	“If Pakistan invested in...” arguments
13	Punctuation and sentence polish	comma, semicolon, colon, dash, apostrophe, quotation	Examiner-safe punctuation; no comma splices
14	Removing errors I	FPSC sentence-correction families	Exam-style rewrite with smallest change
15	Removing errors II	Parallelism, modifiers, diction, Urduisms	Cleaning a dirty CSS paragraph
16	From grammar to paragraph	Topic sentence, cohesion, academic register	One full argumentative paragraph
17	Capstone: timed mini-essay and remediation	All previous rules under 40 minutes	Diagnostic map for the rest of CSS prep

6. Weekly rhythm (if you teach two or three times a week)

Two sessions a week (9 weeks):

Mon/Thu or Tue/Fri. Diagnostic in Session 1. Mid-test after Session 9. Final in Session 17.

Three sessions a week (6 weeks):

Same order. Do not skip Sessions 14–15; error hunting is where marks are recovered.

One session a week (17 weeks):

Possible, but homework must be marked every week or the grammar will not stick.

7. Assessment

Instrument	When	Marks	Purpose
Diagnostic (30 items + 80-word paragraph)	Start of Session 1	Unmarked or 50	Placement; teacher sees Urdu-medium vs English-medium gaps
Exit ticket	End of every session	4–6 items	Did today land?
Homework	After every session	10–15 items + 80–120 words	Spaced practice
Mid-course test	After Session 9, or first 20 min of Session 10	50	Tenses + agreement + parts of speech
Final timed mini-essay	Session 17	25 language + 15 structure	Transfer to essay conditions
Error log	Running	—	Student records every personal mistake; teacher samples logs in Sessions 9, 14, 17

Rubrics live in [assessments/](#).

8. Standard session shape (90 minutes)

Minutes	Block	Teacher does	Student does
0–8	Recap / homework spot-check	3 sentences on the board from last homework	Correct in notebooks
8–28	Teach the rule	Board + contrastive Urdu box	Copy the formula sheet lines only
28–48	Guided drill	Cold-call, then pair check	Diagnose → rewrite
48–72	Essay transfer	One CSS topic, 6–8 sentences or a paragraph	Write, then swap
72–85	Error hunt from student writing	Public correction of 4 real sentences (anonymous)	Copy corrected versions
85–90	Homework + exit ticket	Assign; collect tickets	4 quick items

9. Materials the teacher needs

- Whiteboard and two colours (rule vs example)
- This pack (one session file per class)

- Diagnostic, mid-test, final booklet (print from [assessments/](#))
- Formula sheet (print for Session 1; students bring it every week)
- Highlighter for error logs
- Optional: Dawn / Express Tribune editorial (one paragraph) for Sessions 13–16

Students need: notebook divided into **Rules / Drills / Error log / Mini-writing**, black/blue pen, red pen for correction.

10. What each session file contains

Every file in [sessions/](#) has the same skeleton so a substitute teacher can pick it up:

1. **Session identity** — title, module, exam link
2. **Outcomes** — 3–5 observable skills
3. **Teacher plan** — timed 90-minute script, board work, traps
4. **Student notes** — rules, tables, CSS examples
5. **Urdu-interference box** — the local mistake
6. **Class drill** — do in the room
7. **Essay-transfer task** — always a CSS-flavoured topic
8. **Homework** — 45–60 minutes
9. **Exit ticket**
10. **Teacher mark scheme pointers** — what to accept / reject

Full answers: [answer-keys/SESSIONS-01-T0-17-KEYS.md](#) .

11. Pass standard (teacher's professional judgement)

A student is **language-ready for full CSS essay practice** when all of these are true:

- Fewer than **3 grammar faults** per 100 words in a timed paragraph
- No tense drift inside a paragraph
- Articles and prepositions at least 80% accurate
- Can convert a quotation to indirect speech
- Can write 8–10 sentences in mixed active/passive on purpose
- Can name the error in a faulty sentence before correcting it

Until then, do not send the student into 2500-word essay drills. Length without grammar produces a longer fail.

12. Recommended sequence after this course

1. Full CSS essay structure (outline, thesis, 8–10 paragraphs, conclusion)
2. Precis, comprehension, pair of words, translation
3. Content banks: governance, climate, gender, foreign policy, economy, technology
4. Weekly timed 2500–3000 word essay under exam conditions

This 17-session pack is the foundation. Do not invert the order.

Teacher Handbook

Use this before Session 1 and as a weekly briefing. Session files contain the lesson; this file contains the **method**.

1. The student in front of you

CSS batches in Pakistan are mixed:

Profile	Typical strength	Typical wound
English-medium, big-city	Reading fluency, some vocabulary	Bombast, run-ons, fake “CSS style”
Urdu-medium, solid content	Ideas, current affairs memory	Articles, prepositions, tense, word order
Repeaters	Familiarity with topics	Fossilised errors (“I am agree”)
High-vocabulary crammers	Rare words	Wrong collocation, wrong register

Rule: teach to the wound, not the ego. A student who can recite 40 quotations still fails if the verb does not agree.

2. What FPSC is actually marking in language

From examiner feedback on the Essay paper, language is not a side issue. The subject experts ask for:

- correct and flawless language
- appropriate vocabulary (not ornamental)
- clarity
- coherence between paragraphs
- cohesion inside the argument
- a proper beginning with a topic sentence
- an impressive finish

Your job in 17 sessions is **flawless language + cohesion**. Content and “research-based knowledge” are a later course. If you mix too much current affairs into grammar class, the grammar will not be learned.

3. Non-negotiable classroom rules

1. **English in the room** after the first 5 minutes of Session 1. Urdu is allowed only in the labelled “Urdu box” moments (30–60 seconds to contrast a structure).
2. **No rewriting by taste.** Students must name the rule: *agreement / article / tense / preposition / voice / narration / punctuation / diction*.
3. **Smallest correct change** — same instruction as CSS sentence correction. Do not let students recast a whole sentence to hide the error.
4. **Anonymous public correction.** Take 4 student sentences each class. Do not name the writer. Shame kills batches; patterns must still be shown.
5. **Error log is compulsory.** If there is no log, the homework is incomplete.

6. **British spelling.** Correct *organization* → *organisation* unless a proper noun.

7. **Ban the fake CSS sentence.** “*In this contemporary epoch of globalization, it is crystal clear that...*” is a fail style. Prefer short, exact English.

4. How to mark homework in 20 minutes (even with 40 scripts)

Do **not** line-edit every word. Use a four-code system. Write the code in the margin; the student repairs.

Code	Meaning	Student action
T	Tense / time	Fix the verb form and time marker
A	Article / agreement	a/an/the/zero or SVA
P	Preposition / pair / punctuation	Replace the small word or mark
S	Structure (fragment, run-on, voice, modifier)	Rebuild the sentence

Pick **one gold sentence** and **one wrecked sentence** per script. Star the gold. Bracket the wreck. In the next recap, put two wrecks on the board.

If you try to correct everything, you will drown and the student will copy your English instead of learning the rule.

5. How to handle mixed ability

- **Weaker students:** they must master Sessions 2, 5, 6, 9, 14. That is articles, prepositions, present tense, agreement, error hunting.
- **Stronger students:** same drill, then an extra “stretch” sentence in each session file. Do not let them skip the drill; their errors are usually hidden in long sentences.
- **Pairing:** always pair a fluent speaker with a content-strong Urdu-medium student for the essay-transfer block. The fluent student may not be the grammatically accurate one. Check.

6. Speaking vs writing

CSS is a written exam. Do not spend the hour on oral fluency games. A short oral recitation of a formula is useful (30 seconds). The marks come from the page. Every session ends with writing.

7. The “CSS topic” bank for transfer tasks

Stay inside these themes so grammar class also feels like CSS class, without becoming a current-affairs lecture:

1. Governance and the rule of law
2. Education and the youth bulge
3. Climate and water
4. Economy, inflation, unemployment
5. Gender and social justice
6. Extremism and social cohesion

7. Technology, AI, social media
8. Foreign policy and regional peace
9. Population and urbanisation
10. Democracy, civil-military balance (handle with academic tone only)

One theme per transfer task is enough. The student is practising **sentences**, not producing a full essay until Session 17.

8. Banned student habits (put this on the wall)

- Starting every essay with a dictionary definition
 - *According to me*
 - *Last but not the least*
 - *I am agree / I am not agree*
 - *Discuss about / comprise of / despite of / return back*
 - *The need of the hour is that government should take concrete steps* (empty)
 - Three clauses joined by commas
 - Changing tense every sentence
 - Quoting without a reporting frame
 - Using *thou, henceforth, wherein* to look classical
-

9. What success looks like by session cluster

After Session 5: student can label parts of speech in a 25-word sentence and repair articles/prepositions.

After Session 9: a 120-word paragraph stays in one tense and agrees throughout.

After Session 13: student can punctuate and convert voice/narration.

After Session 17: a 250–300 word mini-essay on a known CSS theme, timed, with a thesis, three body sentences-groups, and a conclusion — language not collapsing.

10. If you only have 12 sessions

Cut in this order (painful but honest):

- Fold Session 4 into 2–3 (adjectives/adverbs as a 15-minute insert)
- Fold Session 12 into 8 (conditionals as future-tense extension)
- Keep 14 and 15. Error removal is the exam skill.
- Never cut 6, 9, 16, 17.

If you have extra time, repeat 14–15 with new sentences. That is the highest-yield revision.

11. Ethics and tone

CSS essays on gender, religion, and civil-military relations require **academic calm**. Model that tone in example sentences. Do not use partisan slogans as grammar examples. Do not mock a student's accent. Correct the sentence.

12. Before you walk in (2-minute checklist)

- ☐ Session file open; answers not on the student printout
- ☐ Three recap sentences from last week's homework
- ☐ Board plan: formula on the left, examples on the right
- ☐ Transfer topic written at the top before class starts
- ☐ Exit tickets cut
- ☐ Error-log reminder
- ☐ Phone away; students write on paper, not only on screens

Student Formula Sheet

Print this after Session 1. Bring it to every class. Add your own errors on the back.

British spelling. CSS essays are written in this standard.

1. The sentence

- **Sentence** = subject + finite verb + complete thought.
- **Fragment** = missing subject or finite verb.
- **Run-on** = two sentences glued with a comma or with nothing.
- Fix a run-on with a full stop, a semicolon, or a coordinator (*and, but, so, yet, or*).

2. Parts of speech (eight)

Class	Job	CSS watch-out
Noun	names	<i>information, furniture, advice</i> — no plural -s
Pronoun	replaces a noun	<i>one of them is</i> ; it needs a clear noun
Adjective	describes a noun	<i>a major challenge</i> , not <i>a majorly challenge</i>
Verb	action or state	every clause needs one finite verb
Adverb	describes verb/adj/adv	<i>severely, well, never</i>
Preposition	relates a noun to the sentence	<i>discuss (no about)</i> ; <i>depend on</i>
Conjunction	joins	<i>although</i> OR <i>but</i> , not both
Interjection	emotion	almost never in a CSS essay

3. Articles

- **a / an** = one of many, first mention, job/class (*a judge, an honest effort*).
- **the** = known, unique, superlative, previously mentioned (*the Constitution, the Indus*).
- **zero article** = general plural or uncountable (*Poverty increases unrest. / Water is scarce.*).
- *one of the* + **plural noun** + **singular verb**: *One of the reasons is...*

4. Tense map (12 forms)

Time	Simple	Continuous	Perfect	Perfect continuous
Present	<i>the state fails</i>	<i>is failing</i>	<i>has failed</i>	<i>has been failing</i>
Past	<i>failed</i>	<i>was failing</i>	<i>had failed</i>	<i>had been failing</i>
Future	<i>will fail</i>	<i>will be failing</i>	<i>will have failed</i>	<i>will have been failing</i>

Essay default: present simple for claims that are generally true; past simple for dated events; present perfect for a past that still matters (*Pakistan has faced energy shortages for decades*).

Never mix *yesterday* with present perfect.

5. Sequence of tenses

If the reporting or main verb is past, the next verb usually steps back:

- *He said that the policy was flawed.*
- *The commission reported that funds had been misused.*

6. Subject–verb agreement

- Distance does not change the subject: *The quality of the reforms is poor.*
- *Each, every, everyone, nobody, one* → singular.
- *Either X or Y / Neither X nor Y* → verb follows the **nearer** subject.
- *Many a* + singular: *Many a student fails the essay.*
- Uncountable: *The news is; The police are (BrE).*

7. Voice

- Active: doer + verb + object. Prefer this in argument.
- Passive: object + *be* + past participle (+ *by* doer). Use when the doer is unknown, obvious, or less important than the action.
- Do not write empty passives: *Steps should be taken.* Name the actor.

8. Narration (reporting)

When the reporting verb is past:

Direct	Indirect
<i>is / am</i>	<i>was</i>
<i>are</i>	<i>were</i>
<i>has / have</i>	<i>had</i>
<i>did / past simple</i>	<i>had</i> + past participle
<i>will</i>	<i>would</i>
<i>can</i>	<i>could</i>
<i>may</i>	<i>might</i>
<i>now / today / tomorrow / yesterday / here</i>	<i>then / that day / the next day / the previous day / there</i>

- Statements: *said that...* / *told* + object + *that...*
- Yes/no questions: *asked if/whether* + **statement order**.
- Wh-questions: keep *what/why/how* + statement order.
- Commands: *told/asked/ordered* + object + *to / not to*.

9. Conditionals

Type	Form	Use
0	<i>If + present, present</i>	laws of nature / always true
1	<i>If + present, will/can/may</i>	real future policy
2	<i>If + past, would/could</i>	imagined present (<i>If I were</i>)
3	<i>If + had + PP, would have + PP</i>	missed past chance
Mixed	<i>If + had + PP, would + verb</i>	past cause, present result

- *unless* already means *if not* → no extra *not*.
- *until* = up to a time. Do not write *until you don't*.

10. High-frequency prepositions

- *interested in, depend on, consist of, comprise (no of), discuss (no about)*
- *prefer X to Y; senior/junior/superior/inferior to***
- *despite / in spite of* (not despite of*)*
- *arrive in a city, arrive at a building*
- *angry with a person, angry at a thing*
- *since + point (since 2018); for + period (for six years)*

11. Punctuation that saves marks

- Full stop ends a thought.
- Comma cannot join two full sentences (comma splice).
- Semicolon joins two related sentences.
- Colon introduces an explanation or a list.
- Apostrophe: *Pakistan's economy*; *its* = possessive of *it*; *it's* = *it is* (avoid *it's* in essays).
- Quotation marks for exact words; then a reporting verb.

12. Parallelism

After *and / or / not only...but also / both...and*, keep the same form:

- *The state must tax fairly, spend honestly and explain publicly.*
- Not: *tax fairly, spending honestly and explanation.*

13. Pakistani English traps (memorise)

Don't write	Write
I am agree	I agree
discuss about	discuss
comprise of	comprise / consist of

Don't write	Write
despite of	despite
although... but	although... / but...
return back	return
one of the reason	one of the reasons
informations / furnitures	information / furniture
peoples (unless nations)	people
since five years	for five years
if I will go	if I go
unless you don't	unless you
according to me	in my view / I argue that
the need of the hour	the priority is / Pakistan must
last but not the least	finally
did not went	did not go
more better	better
very unique	unique

14. Mini paragraph formula

1. **Topic sentence** (present simple claim).
2. **Because** (reason).
3. **Evidence** (dated past, or present perfect for a continuing fact).
4. **However** (limit or counter).
5. **Therefore** (link to the thesis).

Keep one time-frame unless the meaning must move.

15. Before you hand the paper in

- Circle every verb. Do they agree? Is the time right?
- Scan *a/an/the*.
- Scan *of/in/on/to/for*.
- Look for *although...but* and *unless...not*.
- Read the last sentence of each paragraph. Does the next paragraph start from it?

Student Print Pack — What to photocopy

Give this list to the photocopy shop / academic coordinator.

Before Session 1 (everyone)

- 00-SYLLABUS.md (or a 2-page extract: aims + session list + session shape)
- FORMULA-SHEET.md (double-sided; students bring it every week)
- assessments/01-diagnostic.md
- assessments/04-error-log-template.md (several copies)
- sessions/01-the-css-sentence.md — **student notes + drills only** if you are saving paper (omit the teacher plan table)

Each subsequent session

Print that week's sessions/NN-....md.

If paper is tight: print **Student notes, Urdu box, Class drill, Essay-transfer, Homework, Exit ticket**. Skip **Teacher plan** and **Teacher mark pointers**.

Tests

- After Session 9: assessments/02-mid-course-test.md
- Session 17: assessments/03-final-mini-essay.md (rubric on the back)

Never photocopy for students until after the attempt

- answer-keys/SESSIONS-01-T0-17-KEYS.md
- TEACHER-HANDBOOK.md (optional teacher-only)

Notebook rule (write on the board in Session 1)

Divide a register into four parts:

1. Rules (formulae only)
2. Drills
3. Error log
4. Mini-writing

Black/blue pen for first attempt. Red (or a second colour) for repair. The repair, not the first attempt, is the learning.

Part B — Seventeen sessions

Teach from the plan; study from the notes. Each class ends in writing.

Session 1 — The CSS Sentence and the Examiner's Demand

Module A • Foundation

Duration: 90 minutes

Exam link: Essay paper (articulation, expression, technical treatment of style) + every grammar question in Precis & Composition

Outcomes

By the end of this session the student can:

1. State, in one sentence, what FPSC is testing in the English Essay paper.
2. Separate a **sentence**, a **fragment**, and a **run-on**.
3. Find the **subject** and the **finite verb** in a 20–30 word sentence.
4. Name the four sentence types (simple, compound, complex, compound-complex) and use two of them in a CSS paragraph.
5. Sit the diagnostic test and start an **error log**.

Teacher plan (90 minutes)

Time	Move	Board / talk
0–12	Why language fails CSS	Write the official essay instruction. Underline <i>articulation</i> , <i>expression</i> , <i>technical treatment</i> . Tell the room: ideas without grammar still fail.
12–22	Diagnostic (see assessments/01-diagnostic.md)	Silent. No phones. Collect scripts.
22–40	Teach the sentence	Subject + finite verb + complete thought. Fragment / run-on. Four types.
40–55	Guided drill	Diagnose 8 items: S / F / R then rewrite.
55–78	Essay transfer	Topic: <i>Education is the cheapest defence of a nation</i> . Students write 6 sentences: 2 simple, 2 compound, 2 complex. Swap and label.
78–86	Public correction	Four anonymous student sentences. Name the fault.

Time	Move	Board / talk
86–90	Homework + exit ticket	Error log setup.

Traps to kill on day one

- The “CSS opening”: *In this contemporary era it is crystal clear that...* Ban it.
- Treating a title as a sentence: *Poverty in Pakistan*. That is a fragment.
- Comma splice: *Inflation is high, the poor suffer.*

Stretch for strong students: write one compound-complex sentence on the same topic without exceeding 35 words.

Student notes

1. What the examiner wants

The CSS English Essay is one paper, 100 marks. You choose a topic from a wide list and write a full essay. FPSC says it will examine:

- comprehensive, research-based knowledge
- **articulation** (can you say the idea cleanly?)
- **expression** (is the English controlled?)
- **technical treatment of essay style** (outline, paragraphs, argument, close)

This 17-session course builds the last three. Knowledge without a working sentence is a long, expensive fail.

2. The only unit that matters: the sentence

A **sentence** is a group of words that contains:

1. a **subject** (who/what the sentence is about)
2. a **finite verb** (a verb with tense: *is, fails, passed, will reform*)
3. a **complete thought** (it can stand alone)

Examples:

- *Pakistan needs a competent civil service.*
Subject: *Pakistan*. Finite verb: *needs*. Complete.
- *Because Pakistan needs a competent civil service.*
Fragment. *Because* leaves the thought unfinished.
- *Pakistan needs a competent civil service, recruitment is politicised.*
Run-on (comma splice). Two sentences pretending to be one.

3. Finite verb vs verbal

ing and *to + verb* are **not** finite by themselves:

- *Controlling inflation.* → fragment
- *Controlling inflation requires independent data.* → sentence (*requires* is finite)

4. Four sentence types (learn the names)

Type	Pattern	CSS example
Simple	one independent clause	<i>Climate stress is a security issue.</i>
Compound	two independents joined by <i>and/but/so/or/yet</i> or a semicolon	<i>Climate stress is a security issue, and water conflict will follow.</i>
Complex	one independent + one or more dependents (<i>because, although, if, which, when</i>)	<i>Although budgets exist, implementation remains weak.</i>
Compound-complex	at least two independents + one dependent	<i>Although budgets exist, implementation remains weak, and donors have noticed.</i>

For CSS, **complex** is the workhorse. It shows cause, contrast, and condition. Do not stack four clauses into one monster. Examiners call that “flawed sentence structure.”

5. How to find the subject in a long sentence

Ignore prepositional phrases (*of the reforms, in the rural areas*).

- *The quality of the recent reforms in the energy sector is still doubtful.*
Subject = *quality*, not *reforms*, not *sector*.

6. Three legal ways to join complete thoughts

1. Full stop: *Inflation is high. The poor suffer.*
2. Semicolon: *Inflation is high; the poor suffer.*
3. Coordinator: *Inflation is high, and the poor suffer.*

Illegal: comma alone. Illegal: nothing at all.

7. Register: CSS is not a speech, not a novel

Write adult, calm, exact English.

Weak: *Our beloved country is facing a lot of problems nowadays.*

Stronger: *Pakistan faces a fiscal and administrative crisis that the present policy mix has not eased.*

You do not need rare words. You need the **right common words** in the right order.

| Urdu-interference box

Urdu often runs clauses together with *aur* and *ke*. Direct translation produces:

- *Pakistan is an agricultural country, most people live in villages, they have no facilities.*
Three sentences. Put stops. Or write: *Pakistan remains largely agrarian; most citizens still live in villages with weak public services.*

| Class drill (10 minutes)

Label each item **S** (sentence), **F** (fragment), or **R** (run-on). Rewrite F and R.

1. Governance without accountability.

2. The civil service recruits talent, it does not always retain it.
 3. When a state cannot tax fairly.
 4. Water scarcity threatens both farms and cities.
 5. Because the census was delayed the planning stayed blind.
 6. Social media spreads rumour it also spreads evidence.
 7. To reform the police overnight.
 8. Education cannot wait until the economy recovers.
-

Essay-transfer task (22 minutes)

Topic: **Education is the cheapest defence of a nation.**

Write **six numbered sentences**:

- 2 simple
- 2 compound (use *and* / *but* / *so*)
- 2 complex (use *because* / *although* / *if*)

Underline every finite verb. Circle every subject.

Peer check: if a partner cannot find a finite verb, it is not a sentence.

Homework (45–60 minutes)

1. Copy the Formula Sheet section 1 into your error-log notebook.
 2. From a Dawn editorial, copy **five** sentences. Label each type (simple / compound / complex / compound-complex).
 3. Rewrite the following as correct English (do not change the meaning):
 - a. Poverty is increasing, government is not serious.
 - b. Although the policy is good but implementation is weak.
 - c. Pakistan facing many challenges in education sector.
 - d. Because the youth is frustrated.
 - e. Climate change is real it is already here.
 4. Write 80 words on *Why a CSS essay fails*. Use at least two complex sentences. No dictionary definition.
 5. Start the **error log**: three columns — *My sentence* / *Fault name* / *Corrected sentence*.
-

Exit ticket (4 minutes)

1. Write one legal definition of a sentence.
 2. Correct: *Inflation is high, the poor suffer.*
 3. Is this a sentence? *While the state borrowed heavily.* Yes/No + reason.
 4. Name the four sentence types.
-

| Teacher mark pointers

- Accept British or American comma-before-*and* in a list; do not accept comma splices.
- *Because the census was delayed the planning stayed blind* is a **sentence** (complex) even without a comma; prefer a comma after the dependent clause when it comes first.
- Homework 3b must drop either *although* or *but*, not keep both.
- Do not award style marks for quotations in this session. We are building the sentence unit only.

Session 2 — Parts of Speech I: Nouns, Pronouns, Articles

Module A • Foundation

Duration: 90 minutes

Exam link: Grammar & vocabulary (articles); sentence correction; every CSS paragraph

Outcomes

The student can:

1. Sort nouns into countable, uncountable, and collective.
2. Use *one of the + plural noun + singular verb*.
3. Keep a pronoun's **antecedent** clear and in agreement.
4. Choose **a / an / the / zero article** in CSS topics (the state, poverty, the Constitution, education).
5. Repair the ten article errors that FPSC recycles.

Teacher plan (90 minutes)

Time	Move
0–8	Recap: three fragments/run-ons from Session 1 homework on the board.
8–30	Teach nouns (count/uncount/collective), pronouns, articles. Table on the left; CSS examples on the right.
30–48	Drill: article cloze + <i>one of the</i> + pronoun reference.
48–72	Transfer: 120-word paragraph on <i>Poverty is a threat to national security</i> — circle every <i>a/an/the</i> , underline nouns. Pair audit.
72–85	Public correction of article/pronoun faults.
85–90	Homework and exit ticket.

Traps: *an university* (wrong; *a university* — sound of yoo); *a honest* (wrong; *an honest* — silent h); *the Pakistan* (wrong except *the Pakistan Army* etc.); *informations*.

Stretch: explain *the* before adjectives used as nouns: *the poor, the educated, the unemployed*.

Student notes

1. Why parts of speech come first

If you cannot name the job of a word, you cannot repair it. CSS sentence correction is diagnosis, not guesswork. We start with the naming words.

2. Nouns

A **noun** names a person, place, thing, idea, or event.

Kind	Test	CSS examples	Fault
Countable	you can number them	<i>a reform, two courts, many voters</i>	<i>many evidence</i>
Uncountable	no <i>a/an</i> , no plural -s	<i>information, advice, furniture, machinery, progress, poverty, inflation</i>	<i>informations, advices, furnitures</i>
Collective	group as one unit	<i>government, committee, cabinet, police</i>	verb number: BrE <i>the committee has</i> ; <i>the police are</i>
Proper	named, capitalised	<i>Pakistan, the Indus, Parliament, the Constitution</i>	<i>pakistan, the parliament</i> (in CSS, <i>Parliament</i> when meaning the institution)

Quantity words

- Countable: *many, few, a few, several, a number of, each*
- Uncountable: *much, little, a little, an amount of*
- Both: *some, any, a lot of, plenty of*

A number of reforms are overdue. (plural)

The number of reforms is small. (singular)

3. The deadly pattern: *one of the*

Formula: **one of the** + plural noun + singular verb

- *One of the reasons is elite capture.*
- *One of the problems that face the state is water theft.*
(*that face* agrees with *problems*; *is* agrees with *one*.)

Never: *one of the reason is.*

4. Pronouns

A pronoun stands for a noun already clear to the reader (the **antecedent**).

Rules:

1. **Agreement:** *Pakistan must reform its tax base.* (country = *it/its*, not *their*, unless you are personifying in informal talk — don't.)
2. **Each / every / everyone / nobody** take *he* or *she* in old style, or recast in the plural: *Citizens must pay their taxes.* Recasting is cleaner.
3. **Who / whom:** *who* = subject; *whom* = object. *The officer who signed; the officer whom the court summoned.* If in doubt in an essay, recast: *the officer the court summoned.*
4. **Which / that:** *which* often adds extra information (commas); *that* defines. *The bill that failed in the Senate...*
5. **Vague this/it:** never start a paragraph with *This is very important* unless *this* points to a named noun. Write *This delay...* / *This gap in data...*

5. Articles — the CSS minefield

English has **a / an / the / nothing (zero)**. Urdu has no matching system. This is why article errors are the loudest “non-native” signal in a CSS script.

a / an (indefinite)

Use for one of a class, first mention, or a job.

- *A state cannot survive without tax.*
- *She became an officer.*
- *an hour, an honest effort, an MBA, an FPSC paper* (go by **sound**)
- *a university, a European state, a one-time grant* (sound of yoo / y / w)

the (definite)

Use when the reader can identify which one:

- already mentioned: *A policy was launched. The policy failed.*
- unique: *the sun, the Constitution, the Prime Minister, the Indus, the poor*
- superlative / ordinal: *the worst crisis, the first census*
- known institutions: *the Supreme Court, the State Bank, the United Nations*
- rivers, mountain ranges, oceans, newspapers: *the Himalayas, the Indian Ocean, the Dawn* (paper often styled *Dawn*)

zero article

No article for:

- general uncountable or general plural: *Poverty breeds unrest. Courts need independence.*
- most country names: *Pakistan, Turkey, China* (but *the United States, the United Kingdom, the Netherlands, the Punjab* in some styles — in CSS write *Punjab* or *the Punjab* consistently; this course uses *Punjab* for the province and *the Punjab* only if you mean the historic region. Prefer *Punjab*.)
- languages, sports, academic subjects: *Urdu, English, hockey, economics*
- meals, in general: *after breakfast*

Good CSS pair

- *Education is a public good.* (zero: education in general)
- *The education budget is still too small.* (a specific budget)

6. Capital letters

Capitalise proper nouns, not big ideas. *democracy, inflation, climate change* stay lower case unless they start the sentence. *Islam, Christianity, Parliament, Article 19* take capitals as names.

Urdu-interference box

Urdu-pattern English	Correct
<i>The Pakistan is a developing country.</i>	<i>Pakistan is a developing country.</i>
<i>She gave me an advice.</i>	<i>She gave me advice / a piece of advice.</i>
<i>The inflation is increasing.</i> (as a general claim)	<i>Inflation is increasing.</i>
<i>Peoples of Pakistan</i> (meaning citizens)	<i>The people of Pakistan</i>
<i>One of my friend</i>	<i>One of my friends</i>

Class drill

A. Article cloze (a / an / the / —)

1. ___ rule of law is not ___ slogan; it is ___ daily habit of institutions.
2. ___ information that ___ bureau released was incomplete.
3. ___ honest broker is rare in ___ regional politics.
4. ___ poverty in ___ Thar is not ___ same as poverty in a city slum.
5. ___ United Nations warned about ___ water stress in ___ Indus basin.

B. Repair

6. One of the main cause of unrest are unemployment.
7. Pakistan must protect their farmers.
8. This is alarming. (Make *this* specific, using *census delay*.)
9. She is a honest civil servant.
10. Many advices were ignored.

Essay-transfer task

Write **120 words** on: **Poverty is a threat to national security.**

Constraints:

- At least two uncountable nouns used correctly (*poverty, security, information, inflation, evidence*).
- One sentence with *one of the...*
- Circle every article. If a noun has no article, write Ø above it.

Homework

1. Learn uncountables: *information, advice, news, furniture, luggage, machinery, equipment, progress, research, evidence, work, damage, traffic, knowledge, education, poverty, inflation, corruption*. Write one CSS sentence for each of eight of them.
2. Correct:
 - a. An university degree does not guarantee the employment.
 - b. The Parliament passed a bill on the climate.
 - c. Each of the provinces have a grievance.
 - d. Poor needs the state.
 - e. One of the most serious problem are extremism.
3. 100 words: *The Constitution is a living document*. Control *the*.
4. Error log: copy every article fault the teacher marked in Session 1 writing.

Exit ticket

1. Why is *informations* wrong?

2. Fill: *One of the ___ (reform) ___ (be) delayed.*
 3. *a* or *an*: ___ FPSC examiner; ___ unique case; ___ hour.
 4. Correct: *Pakistan must reform their civil service.*
-

Teacher mark pointers

- Item A1: *The* rule of law; *a* slogan; *a* daily habit.
- A4: zero *poverty* (general) then *the Thar*; *the same*.
- Do not accept *the Pakistan*.
- *The Parliament* is commonly used; prefer *Parliament* as institution, *the Parliament* if meaning this sitting. Accept both if consistent.
- *Poor needs the state* → *The poor need the state*.

Session 3 — Parts of Speech II: Verbs, Auxiliaries, Modals

Module A • Foundation

Duration: 90 minutes

Exam link: Tense questions; essay tone (force vs hedge); narration later

Outcomes

The student can:

1. Find the **finite verb** in a clause and say whether it is lexical or auxiliary.
2. Form questions and negatives with *do / be / have*.
3. Use **modals** to control argument: *must, should, ought to, can, could, may, might, would, will, need, dare*.
4. Avoid *I am agree* and *the government should to take*.
5. Write a policy recommendation with graded force (must / should / may).

Teacher plan (90 minutes)

Time	Move
0–8	Recap articles: three student faults from Session 2.
8–28	Finite vs non-finite; <i>do/be/have</i> ; modal chart with force ladder .
28–48	Drill: repair + choose the modal that matches the claim.
48–72	Transfer: eight recommendations on <i>climate and water</i> , using a different modal each time. Then rewrite two as full sentences with a lexical verb that is not <i>take steps</i> .
72–85	Kill empty verbs: <i>do, make, take steps, happen</i> . Replace with exact verbs.
85–90	Homework, exit ticket.

Traps: *must to, should to, can be able to, would + present after if I will, I am agree, it is must*.

Stretch: difference *need not* (no obligation) vs *must not* (prohibition).

Student notes

1. The verb is the engine

Every clause in a CSS essay needs a **finite verb** — a verb that shows tense and agrees with the subject.

- Lexical (main) verb: *fail, reform, tax, argue, threaten*
- Auxiliary (helping) verb: *be, do, have*

- Modal: *can, could, may, might, must, shall, should, will, would, ought to*

A sentence with no finite verb is a fragment: *The state trying to reform.* → *The state is trying to reform.*

2. The three auxiliaries

Auxiliary	Job	CSS example
be	continuous + passive	<i>The bill is being debated. The bill was passed.</i>
have	perfect	<i>The state has failed to tax the elite.</i>
do	questions, negatives, emphasis in simple tenses	<i>The policy does not work. Does the policy work?</i>

Negatives:

- *do/does/did not* + base form: *did not go** (*never did not went**)
- *is/are/was/were not*
- *has/have/had not* + past participle

3. Non-finite forms (do not treat them as the main verb)

- Infinitive: *to reform*
- Present participle / gerund: *reforming*
- Past participle alone: *reformed* (needs *be* or *have* to be finite)

Reforming the police is a **noun phrase** (gerund), not a sentence.

4. Modal ladder for CSS argument

Modals do not take -s. They take a **base verb** with no *to* (except *ought to*).

Force	Modal	When to use in an essay
Obligation, strong policy	must	constitutional duty, red line
Advice, recommendation	should / ought to	good policy, not yet law
Ability	can / could	capacity of the state or a reform
Possibility	may / might	hedge; you are not a prophet
Future / prediction	will	likely result if a condition holds
Hypothetical / polite / past of will	would	type-2 conditional; reported speech
No necessity	need not	<i>The state need not copy every foreign model.</i>
Prohibition	must not	<i>The state must not politicise data.</i>

Wrong: *The government should to take concrete steps.*

Right: *The government should publish the true circular debt.*

Wrong: *It is must that we reform.*

Right: *Reform is necessary. / Pakistan must reform.*

Wrong: *I am agree.*

Right: *I agree.* (*agree* is already a verb. *am* is extra.)

5. Two extras CSS students confuse

- **used to + base:** past habit. *The rupee used to be more stable.*
- **be used to + noun/-ing:** be accustomed. *Farmers are used to canal delays.*
- **need** as modal (rare, formal): *The bill need not wait.* vs main verb: *The bill needs time.*

6. Exact verbs beat empty verbs

Examiners are tired of *take steps, do the needful, make a policy*. Prefer:

Empty	Exact
take steps to improve education	fund teachers, inspect schools, publish results
do a law	enact / enforce a law
make a progress	make progress / improve
give suggestion	recommend / propose
have a look	examine

A CSS paragraph with five *must* and no facts is still empty. Modal + **exact verb** + **object**.

7. Subject-verb preview (full treatment in Session 9)

*The government has (singular). The people **have.*

*Data are (BrE, plural of datum) — in CSS, the data **show is safe; the data shows* is common. This course accepts data show/shows if consistent; prefer figures show* if you want to avoid the fight.*

Urdu-interference box

Don't	Do
<i>I am agree / I am not agree</i>	<i>I agree / I do not agree</i>
<i>He did not went</i>	<i>He did not go</i>
<i>must to / should to / can to</i>	<i>must / should / can + base</i>
<i>It can be able to</i>	<i>It can / It is able to (one, not both)</i>
<i>The government is trying that it should</i>	<i>The government is trying to...</i>

Class drill

A. Underline the finite verb(s). Label lexical / auxiliary / modal.

1. The court has struck down the ordinance.
2. Parliament should not legislate in haste.
3. To tax the retail sector is politically hard.
4. The monsoon is arriving earlier than the models predicted.

B. Repair

5. She did not knew the rule.
6. I am agree with the writer.
7. Government must to reform the police.
8. The state can be able to raise more tax.
9. It is must that inflation is controlled.
10. They are used to live without gas in winter. (intended: habit in the past? or accustomed?) — write **two** correct sentences, one for each meaning.

C. Choose the modal (must / should / may / would / must not)

11. Under the Constitution, the state ___ protect life.
12. A wise cabinet ___ publish the debt figures.
13. If the canal were lined, farmers ___ lose less water.
14. An examiner ___ guess a candidate's party politics from an essay.
15. Next year's flood ___ be worse; the models are not certain.

Essay-transfer task

Theme: **Climate change is a water crisis in Pakistan.**

Write **8 sentences**. Each sentence is a recommendation or a claim. Use each of these once: *must, must not, should, can, cannot, may, might, would*.

Then recast sentence 1 and sentence 3, replacing any empty verb (*take steps, do something*) with an exact verb (*meter, line, store, ration, reforest, price*).

Homework

1. Make a two-column list: 15 empty phrases you personally use (*need of the hour, concrete steps...*) and an exact replacement.
2. Correct 5c–5j style items:
 - a. He was failed in the paper.
 - b. She suggested me to write daily.
 - c. The committee is agreed.
 - d. We should to consider the poor.
 - e. Did the policy succeeded?
3. 100 words on *Why the civil service must be politically neutral*. Circle every modal. You may use *must* only twice.
4. Error log: copy three verb faults.

Exit ticket

1. Why is *I am agree* wrong?
2. Negative of *The policy worked*.

3. *need not* vs *must not* in one line each.

4. Write one sentence with *should* that names a real actor and a real action.

Teacher mark pointers

- 10: *They used to live without gas* (past habit). *They are used to living without gas* (accustomed).
- 11: *must* (constitutional).
- 14: *must not*.
- Homework 2a: *He failed the paper* (not *was failed* unless someone failed him).
- 2b: *She suggested that I write daily* / *She advised me to write daily*. (*suggest me to* is wrong.)
- 2c: *The committee has agreed* / *The committee is agreed on a draft* (second is possible but rare). Prefer *has agreed*.

Session 4 — Parts of Speech III: Adjectives, Adverbs, Determiners

Module A • Foundation

Duration: 90 minutes

Exam link: diction in the essay; comparison errors in sentence correction (*prefer to, senior to, more better*)

Outcomes

The student can:

1. Place an adjective before a noun or after a linking verb (*is, seems, becomes*).
2. Form comparatives and superlatives, including *to* after *senior, junior, superior, inferior, prefer*.
3. Choose *few / a few / little / a little / much / many*.
4. Stop stacking empty intensifiers (*very, highly, crystal clear, utmost*).
5. Turn a vague evaluative sentence into a precise one.

Teacher plan (90 minutes)

Time	Move
0–8	Recap modals: replace <i>take concrete steps</i> on the board.
8–28	Adjective vs adverb; comparison table; determiners of quantity; order of adjectives (light touch).
28–48	Drill: <i>more better, prefer than, few / little, fast vs fastly</i> .
48–72	Transfer: take 8 empty CSS sentences (<i>very important, huge problem</i>) and rewrite with exact adjectives/adverbs or, better, with facts.
72–85	Public correction. Ban <i>very unique, more perfect</i> .
85–90	Homework, exit.

Traps: *she writes good; he ran fastly; prefer than; few vs a few; late / lately; hard / hardly*.

Stretch: adjective order *a major public-sector energy reform* — do not force OSASCOMP unless a student asks; CSS needs clarity, not jewellery.

Student notes

1. Adjective vs adverb

- **Adjective** describes a **noun** or pronoun: *a weak regulator, the policy is weak*.

- **Adverb** describes a **verb, adjective, or other adverb**: *the regulator acted weakly; a surprisingly weak regulator.*

After linking verbs (*be, seem, appear, become, remain, look, feel*), use an adjective:

- *The argument seems sound.* (not *soundly*)
- *The data look reliable.* (not *reliably*)

Manner of action uses an adverb:

- *She argued soundly.*
- *He writes well.* (*good* is the adjective: *a good brief*)

2. Irregular pair that CSS students miss

Adjective	Adverb	Danger
good	well	<i>he did good</i> → <i>he did well</i> / <i>he did good work</i>
fast	fast	<i>no fastly</i>
hard	hard	<i>hardly</i> means <i>almost not</i>
late	late	<i>lately</i> means <i>recently</i>
high	high / highly	<i>highly</i> = very (opinions): <i>highly likely</i>
near	near / nearly	<i>nearly</i> = almost

- *The committee worked hard.* (effort)
- *The committee hardly worked.* (almost no work) — opposite meanings.

3. Comparison

Degree	Short adj.	Long adj.
Positive	<i>weak</i>	<i>effective</i>
Comparative (two)	<i>weaker than</i>	<i>more effective than</i>
Superlative (three+)	<i>the weakest</i>	<i>the most effective</i>

Never double: *more weaker, most weakest, more better, more easier.*

Latin / fixed to (not *than*)

- *prefer X to Y*
- *senior / junior / superior / inferior / prior to***
- *preferable to***

A career in the police is not inferior to a career in the PAS.

Not: *inferior than.*

as...as for equality: *This year's flood was as severe as 2010.*

not so/as...as for inequality.

Uncountable vs countable comparison:

- *less inflation, fewer jobs*

- *less time, fewer hours*

4. Determiners of quantity (CSS gold)

Word	Use	Meaning
few	countable	almost none (negative)
a few	countable	some (positive)
little	uncountable	almost none (negative)
a little	uncountable	some (positive)
many	countable	
much	uncountable (mostly questions/negatives; in essays prefer <i>a great deal of / little</i>)	
several	countable, more than two	
each / every	singular	<i>each province has</i>

- *Few reformers survive the first year.* (grim)
- *A few reformers survived the first year.* (there were some)

5. Empty intensifiers: the fake CSS style

These words are not wrong. They are **cheap** when they replace evidence.

Avoid stacking: *very highly extremely important huge crisis.*

Cheap	Sharper
a very big problem	a fiscal gap equal to X / a gap the size of the education budget
crystal clear	evident / the figures show
utmost importance	indispensable / legally required
huge / massive / gigantic	name the scale
unique	<i>unique</i> already means one of a kind — no <i>very unique</i>
perfect	<i>no more perfect</i>

A CSS examiner has read *the burning issue of the day* five thousand times. Write the issue.

6. Adjectives as a class of people

the poor, the rich, the unemployed, the young take a **plural** verb:

- *The poor pay a higher share of indirect tax.*

7. Hyphenated modifiers

Before a noun, hyphenate a two-word description:

- *a three-year plan, a well-known reformer, a long-term risk*

After the noun: *the plan is three years old; the reformer is well known.*

Urdu-interference box

Don't	Do
<i>She writes good.</i>	<i>She writes well. / Her writing is good.</i>
<i>more better / more worse</i>	<i>better / worse</i>
<i>prefer tea than coffee</i>	<i>prefer tea to coffee</i>
<i>He is senior than me.</i>	<i>He is senior to me.</i>
<i>very unique</i>	<i>unique</i>
<i>too much problems</i>	<i>too many problems</i>
<i>fastly</i>	<i>fast</i>

Class drill

A. Choose the right form

1. The briefing was (clear / clearly). The officer spoke (clear / clearly).
2. She worked (hard / hardly) on the précis; she (hard / hardly) slept.
3. There are (few / a few / little) honest brokers in the market. (Meaning: some exist.)
4. There is (few / little / a little) time left before the monsoon. (Meaning: almost none.)
5. Islamabad is (colder / more colder) than Karachi in January.

B. Repair

6. I prefer governance than slogans.
7. This solution is more better.
8. He ran fastly towards the court.
9. Every provinces have a complaint.
10. The poor is ignored in indirect taxation.
11. She is junior than the secretary.
12. We have too much files and too many work.

Essay-transfer task

Here are eight **cheap** sentences. Rewrite each in **one** cleaner sentence. Add a fact-shaped phrase (it may be invented for practice, but keep it plausible and modest — we are practising language, not fake research).

1. Corruption is a very big problem in Pakistan.
 2. Education is highly important for the youth.
 3. Climate change is the most unique challenge.
 4. The government must take huge steps.
 5. It is crystal clear that inflation hurts the poor.
 6. Social media has a massive impact.
 7. Water is of utmost importance.
 8. Unemployment is a burning issue of the day.
-

Homework

1. Write 12 comparative sentences using: *prefer to, senior to, inferior to, fewer, less, as...as, the most, better, worse, harder, more effective, the least*.
 2. 100 words on *A free press is indispensable to democracy* — you may use very **zero** times.
 3. Collect 10 adjectives from a Dawn editorial. For each, write the adverb if it exists.
 4. Error log: intensifiers you overuse.
-

Exit ticket

1. *hard* vs *hardly* in two short sentences.
 2. Correct: *I prefer coffee than tea*.
 3. *few* or *a few*: you want to sound hopeful about reformers.
 4. Why is *very unique* illogical?
-

Teacher mark pointers

- Transfer task: reward **deletion of intensifier + addition of a concrete noun**. Do not reward a longer sentence that is still empty.
- Item 12: *too many files and too much work*.
- Item 10: *The poor are ignored*.
- Accept *clearly* for both A1 if a student treats *briefing* as how it was delivered; the intended pair is adjective then adverb. Explain, don't over-penalise.

Session 5 — Parts of Speech IV: Prepositions, Conjunctions, Connectors

Module A • Foundation

Duration: 90 minutes

Exam link: FPSC preposition items (high-yield); essay cohesion; *although...but* errors

Outcomes

The student can:

1. Use high-frequency **verb + preposition** collocations that FPSC tests.
2. Distinguish *since/for*, *in/on/at*, *between/among*, *despite/in spite of*.
3. Join clauses with coordinators and subordinators without doubling (*although...but*).
4. Use a short list of **essay connectors** without stuffing every sentence.
5. Write a 6-sentence paragraph whose glue is grammar, not *moreover* in every line.

Teacher plan (90 minutes)

Time	Move
0–8	Recap comparison: <i>prefer to</i> , <i>senior to</i> .
8–30	Preposition map (time/place/cause) + banned doubles. Conjunctions: coordinating vs subordinating. Connect-or diet (12 words).
30–50	Rapid oral: teacher says verb, student throws the preposition. Then written repair of 10 sentences.
50–75	Transfer: paragraph on <i>Social media is a tool, not a policy</i> using exactly three connectors from the approved list.
75–85	Show a paragraph stuffed with <i>moreover</i> , <i>furthermore</i> , <i>in addition</i> — make students strip it.
85–90	Homework, exit.

Traps: *discuss about*, *comprise of*, *despite of*, *according to me*, *between* for more than two, *on 2024*, *since five years*.

Stretch: *in contrast with* vs *in contrast to*; *compared with* (BrE preference) vs *compared to*.

Student notes

1. A preposition is a relating word

It sits before a noun / pronoun / gerund and shows time, place, cause, means, or belonging.

- *in 2022*, *on Monday*, *at night*

- *in Punjab, on the canal, at the secretariat*
- *by law, through the courts, for the poor, of the state*

The object of a preposition is in **object form**: *between you and me** (not *I**).

2. Time and place (the skeleton)

	in	on	at
Time	months, years, long periods: <i>in June, in 2018, in the 1990s</i>	days, dates, surfaces of time: <i>on Monday, on 14 August</i>	clock, meal, festival as a point: <i>at 5 p.m., at dawn, at Eid</i> (also <i>on Eid</i> in some BrE — pick <i>at Eid</i> or <i>on Eid day</i>)
Place	cities, countries, enclosed space: <i>in Karachi, in Pakistan, in the room</i>	surfaces, roads, floors: <i>on Mall Road, on the desk</i>	exact point: <i>at the airport, at the door, at 10 Constitution Avenue</i>

- *arrive in Lahore* (city) / *arrive at the station*
- *since 2018* (starting point) / *for six years* (period)
- *by 2030* (deadline) / *until 2030* (up to that time)

3. Exam collocations (memorise)

Correct	Not
discuss the bill	discuss about the bill
comprise 20 members	comprise of
consist of 20 members	consist 20 members
despite the rain / in spite of the rain	despite of
interested in	interested on
depend / rely on	depend upon is old-fashioned but not wrong; prefer <i>on</i>
accused of , charged with	accused with
good at maths, weak in grammar	good in maths (school English — avoid)
angry with a person, angry at a thing	angry on
die of disease, die in an accident	die from is also used for cause — accept <i>die of</i> in keys
married to	married with
different from	different than (AmE; avoid in CSS)
insist on , live on a wage	
responsible for , reason for	reason of (use <i>cause of</i> / <i>reason for</i>)
congratulated on , prevented from	
prefer X to Y, senior to	
according to the report	according to me → <i>in my view</i>
belong to , listen to , reply to	

4. between vs among; beside vs besides

- *between* — two, or two-sided deals even if more parties: *between the federation and the provinces*
- *among* — a group: *among the parties in the assembly*
- *beside* = next to; *besides* = in addition to

5. Conjunctions: joining without doubling

Coordinating (FANBOYS): *for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so*

They join **equals**. Comma before them when they join two full sentences.

Subordinating: *because, since, although, though, if, unless, until, when, while, after, before, as, whereas, so that*

A subordinator already does the job. Do **not** add a coordinator of the same meaning.

Illegal double	Legal
Although the law exists, but it is dead.	Although the law exists, it is dead. / The law exists, but it is dead.
Because she was late, so she was marked absent.	Because she was late, she was marked absent.
If you work, then only you will pass. (Indian/Pakistani spoken)	If you work, you will pass. / Only if you work will you pass.

unless / until (full drill in Session 12): no extra *not*.

The bill will not pass unless the treasury is present.

Not: *unless the treasury is not present.*

6. Essay connectors — a short, adult list

Use **one or two per paragraph**, not one per sentence.

Job	Use these	Avoid stacking
Add	<i>also, in addition, besides</i>	<i>moreover, furthermore, what is more</i> in every line
Contrast	<i>however, yet, even so, in contrast, on the other hand</i>	<i>contrarily</i>
Cause	<i>because, since, therefore, consequently, as a result</i>	<i>henceforth</i>
Example	<i>for example, for instance, namely</i>	<i>as an illustration of this point</i>
Sequence	<i>first, then, finally</i>	<i>last but not the least</i>
Concession	<i>although, even though, granted that</i>	
Sum	<i>overall, in short, therefore</i>	<i>in a nutshell</i> (too chatty)

however is not a conjunction. It cannot join two sentences with commas alone.

Wrong: *The law exists, however it is dead.*

Right: *The law exists. However, it is dead. / The law exists; however, it is dead.*

Urdu-interference box

Urdu *lekin, magar, kyunke, aur* map badly onto English if you keep both halves.

- *Although... but...* comes from *agarche... lekin...*
- *discuss about* comes from *baat karna about / discuss karna*
- *according to me* from *mere mutabiq* → write *in my view* or, better in CSS, drop the self and make the claim: *The evidence suggests...*

Class drill

A. Insert the preposition (or Ø if none)

1. The panel discussed ____ the draft for three hours.
2. The cabinet consists ____ twenty ministers.
3. The cabinet comprises ____ twenty ministers.
4. ____ 2010 the floods displaced millions.
5. Pakistan has faced circular debt ____ 2010.
6. She is interested ____ water law.
7. He was accused ____ contempt.
8. He was charged ____ contempt.
9. Despite ____ the stay order, demolition began.
10. The officer is senior ____ me.

B. Repair the join

11. Although inflation slowed, but food prices did not.
12. Because the data were late, so the budget was blind.
13. The policy is sound, however it is unfunded.
14. Wait until the House does not rise. (intended: wait until the House rises)
15. Between the four provinces the water fight continues.

Essay-transfer task

Topic: **Social media is a tool, not a policy.**

Write **six sentences** that form one paragraph.

Rules:

- Use **exactly three** connectors, chosen from: *however, because, therefore, for example, although, in contrast, as a result*.
- Use at least two of these collocations: *depend on, consist of, discuss, despite, interested in*.
- No *moreover, furthermore, last but not the least, according to me*.

Then rewrite the same paragraph **without** any connector words, using only clause-joining grammar (*although, because, if, relative clauses*). Compare: which is cleaner?

Homework

1. Memorise the collocation table. Cover the right column and test yourself.
 2. Write 10 original CSS sentences, each locking one collocation.
 3. 120 words on *Federalism in Pakistan depends on water and money*. Use *since/for* once each, *despite* once, *although* once (no *but*).
 4. Find and copy 5 preposition errors from your own previous writing into the error log.
-

Exit ticket

1. *comprise* or *consist* — which takes *of*?
 2. Correct: *discuss about climate*.
 3. Why is *The law exists, however it is dead* wrong?
 4. *since* or *for*: ____ six years; ____ 2018.
-

Teacher mark pointers

- A1: Ø (*discuss the draft*).
- A3: Ø (*comprises twenty*). Some modern usage allows *comprised of*; FPSC keys still prefer no *of*. Teach the exam form.
- A4: *In 2010*.
- A5: *since 2010*.
- A9: *Despite the stay order* (no *of*).
- 14 is a logic trap: *until* + positive verb.
- Reward the transfer paragraph that uses connectors as **hinges**, not as decoration.

Session 6 — Tenses I: The Present System

Module B • Time, voice, narration

Duration: 90 minutes

Exam link: tense items; essay claims about “what is true now”; Precis present-tense summary habit

Outcomes

The student can:

1. Form and name all four **present** tenses.
2. Choose present simple for general CSS claims, present perfect for a past that still matters.
3. Pair time markers with the right present form (*every year, now, since, for, already, yet*).
4. Keep a paragraph in the present system without slipping into random past.
5. Avoid *since five years* and present perfect + *yesterday*.

Teacher plan (90 minutes)

Time	Move
0–8	Recap prepositions: <i>discuss, comprise, since/for</i> .
8–30	Four present forms on a grid. Time-marker column. CSS default: present simple for thesis.
30–50	Marker → tense matching drill. Then cloze paragraph.
50–75	Transfer: 140 words on <i>Corruption weakens the state</i> — present system only . No dated history. Peer check every verb.
75–85	Show a mixed-tense wreck. Restore it.
85–90	Homework, exit.

Traps: *He is knowing; I am agree; Since a long time*; stative verbs in continuous; *has went*.

Stretch: present simple in conditionals (*If the state taxes...*) — preview of Session 12.

Student notes

1. Why tense is an essay skill

Tense is not a school chart. It tells the examiner **when** your claim lives.

- A thesis is usually **present simple**: *Unequal taxation undermines federalism*.
- A continuing crisis is often **present perfect**: *Pakistan has mismanaged water for fifty years*.
- A scene happening around us can be **present continuous**: *Cities are sinking their own water tables*.

If you hop from *undermines* to *undermined* to *will undermining* without a reason, the essay looks uneducated even when the ideas are good.

2. The four present forms

Let the verb be *fail* (regular) and *go* (irregular).

Form	Pattern	Time markers	CSS job
Present simple	<i>fail(s)</i>	<i>always, usually, every year, in general</i>	laws of politics, definitions, thesis, habits of institutions
Present continuous	<i>am/is/are + -ing</i>	<i>now, currently, this year, still</i>	temporary or developing situation
Present perfect	<i>has/have + past participle</i>	<i>already, yet, just, ever, never, since + point, for + period, so far</i>	past with a present result; unfinished time (<i>this decade</i>)
Present perfect continuous	<i>has/have been + -ing</i>	<i>since, for, all day, lately</i>	duration of an activity still going on

Examples:

- Simple: *The Constitution guarantees dignity.*
- Continuous: *The cabinet is bargaining over the NFC award.*
- Perfect: *The cabinet has postponed the census twice.*
- Perfect continuous: *Households have been rationing power all summer.*

3. Present simple: the CSS default

Use it for:

1. thesis and topic sentences
2. facts treated as generally true
3. newspaper-style comment on institutions
4. plot of a precis (the original may be past; a precis often stays present — your precis teacher will confirm)

Form:

- I/you/we/they **fail**
- he/she/it / singular noun **fails**
- negative: *does not fail / do not fail*
- question: *Does the state fail the poor?*

4. Stative verbs: do not put them in continuous

These describe a state, not an action: *know, believe, understand, own, seem, need, consist, contain, prefer, agree, mean, remember, belong.*

- *The file contains evidence.* not *is containing*
- *I agree.* not *I am agreeing* (except “I am agreeing with you on this one point today” — too spoken for CSS)

think: I think the policy is weak (opinion = simple). *The committee is thinking the problem through* (activity = continuous).

5. Present perfect vs past simple (the big fight)

Present perfect	Past simple (Session 7)
no finished time, or time still open	finished time named
<i>The state has raised the policy rate.</i>	<i>The state raised the policy rate in June 2023.</i>
<i>Have you read the report?</i>	<i>Did you read the report yesterday?</i>

Illegal: *The state has raised the rate yesterday.*

Illegal: *Pakistan is independent since 1947. → Pakistan has been independent since 1947. / Pakistan became independent in 1947.*

6. since / for / ago

- **since** + starting point: *since 2018, since the 18th Amendment, since Monday*
- **for** + length: *for six years, for decades*
- **ago** belongs to **past simple**, not present perfect: *six years ago the Act was passed.*

7. Irregular participles you will need

be — was/were — been

do — did — done

go — went — gone

write — wrote — written

rise — rose — risen (prices rise; the state raises taxes)

raise — raised — raised

lie — lay — lain (to rest) vs *lay — laid — laid* (to put)

seek — sought — sought

show — showed — shown

Inflation has risen. The SBP has raised the rate.

Urdu-interference box

Don't	Do
<i>He is knowing the law.</i>	<i>He knows the law.</i>
<i>I am living in Lahore since 2019.</i>	<i>I have been living / have lived in Lahore since 2019.</i>
<i>She has gone yesterday.</i>	<i>She went yesterday.</i>
<i>Since five years the policy failed.</i>	<i>For five years the policy has failed. / The policy failed five years ago.</i>
<i>The sun is rising in the east. (as a law)</i>	<i>The sun rises in the east.</i>

Class drill

A. Name the tense and say why it is used.

1. The rupee depreciates when reserves fall.

2. The rupee is depreciating this quarter.
3. The rupee has depreciated by a third.
4. The rupee has been depreciating since the flood year.

B. Choose

5. Pakistan (is / has been) a federation since 1973.
6. The court (delivers / is delivering / has delivered) the verdict an hour ago.
7. She (knows / is knowing) the file.
8. (Since / For / Ago) 2010, urban flooding (became / has become) normal in Karachi.
9. The committee (has not yet publish / has not yet published / did not yet published) the report.
10. Water tables (fall / are falling / have fallen) every year — pick the best for a **general law**, then the best for **this decade's trend**. Write both sentences.

C. Repair

11. The government has announced the package last Monday.
12. He has wrote a strong outline.
13. Inflation is increased.
14. I am agree that the present simple fits a thesis.

Essay-transfer task

Topic: **Corruption weakens the state.**

Write **140–160 words**.

Rules:

- Use **only** the present system (the four forms above).
- At least one present simple thesis.
- At least one present perfect with *since* or *for*.
- At least one present continuous for a current process.
- Circle every finite verb and write the tense in the margin.
- No *yesterday*, *in 1999*, *after the war* — those force the past.

Peer audit: if a partner finds a past simple, it is a fault unless you can justify a quotation.

Homework

1. Draw the four-box present grid and fill it with *tax*, *write*, *rise*, *raise*.
2. 10 sentences: 2 of each present form, all on *education*.
3. Repair:
 - a. He is working here since 2020.
 - b. Prices have rose.
 - c. Did you ever visit the Supreme Court? (intended: in your life up to now)
 - d. The policy fails last year.
4. Error log: every tense slip from today's paragraph.

Exit ticket

1. Which tense for a CSS thesis?
 2. *since 2018* pairs with which present tense family?
 3. Correct: *She has submitted the form yesterday.*
 4. Why is *is knowing* wrong?
-

Teacher mark pointers

- 6: *delivered* + *an hour ago* = past simple, not present perfect.
- 8: *Since 2010 ... has become.*
- 13: *Inflation has increased / is increasing* (not *is increased* unless passive with agent: *is increased by seasonal demand* — awkward). Prefer *has increased*.
- In the transfer, do not punish a student who needs *must* (modal); modals are fine. Punish *was / were / did*.

Session 7 — Tenses II: The Past System

Module B • Time, voice, narration

Duration: 90 minutes

Exam link: historical examples in essays; past-tense correction; later narration backshift

Outcomes

The student can:

1. Form the four **past** tenses and *used to*.
2. Place a dated CSS example (*in 1971, in 1998, after the 18th Amendment*) in **past simple**.
3. Use **past perfect** only when one past event is earlier than another.
4. Avoid *had went, did not went, was failed* (wrong passive).
5. Insert a 3-sentence historical illustration inside a present-tense argument without contaminating the thesis tense.

Teacher plan (90 minutes)

Time	Move
0–8	Recap: <i>has + yesterday</i> is illegal. Board two student faults.
8–28	Past grid. Past perfect as “earlier past”. <i>used to</i> vs past simple.
28–50	Timeline drill: three events on a line; force past perfect for the earliest.
50–75	Transfer: present-tense thesis on <i>Energy policy needs independence</i> + a boxed 3-sentence past illustration (circular debt / a named year). Return to present for the link.
75–85	Public correction of tense leaks.
85–90	Homework, exit.

Traps: overusing past perfect for everything; *was* + past participle when they mean active (*was failed*); mixing *used to* and *would* without a time frame.

Stretch: *would* for past habit after a time frame: *In the 1990s the rupee would often slide after a political shock.*

Student notes

1. The four past forms

Form	Pattern	Job	CSS example
Past simple	<i>failed / went</i>	finished time, dated event, story	<i>In 2010 the floods displaced millions.</i>

Form	Pattern	Job	CSS example
Past continuous	<i>was/were + -ing</i>	background; interrupted action	<i>While the House was debating, the ordinance lapsed.</i>
Past perfect	<i>had + past participle</i>	earlier of two pasts	<i>By the time the aid arrived, the crop had failed.</i>
Past perfect continuous	<i>had been + -ing</i>	duration before a past point	<i>Farmers had been waiting for water for six weeks when the canal opened.</i>

Markers for **past simple**: *yesterday, last year, in 1999, after the war, ago, that morning.*

2. Past simple is the narrative engine

Form:

- all persons: *failed, went, had, was/were*
- negative: *did not fail* (base form after *did*)
- question: *Did the state fail?*

Irregulars must be automatic: *became, began, brought, built, chose, dealt, felt, found, led, lost, made, meant, paid, said, sold, sent, spent, stood, took, thought, won, wrote.*

3. Past perfect — only when you need “earlier”

Do not sprinkle *had* to look formal.

Use past perfect when the sentence contains **two past times** and you must mark which came first:

- *The government announced a relief package because the flood had destroyed the crop.*
(destruction → then announcement)

If the order is already clear from *after / before / then*, past simple may be enough:

- *After the flood destroyed the crop, the government announced relief.*

Wrong CSS solemnity: *Pakistan had got independence in 1947.*

Right: *Pakistan got / gained independence in 1947.* (one dated event)

4. Past continuous

- *The regulator was sleeping when the crash happened.* (background)
- Not for a completed dated fact: *In 1998 Pakistan was testing nuclear devices* is possible as scene-setting; *Pakistan tested nuclear devices in 1998* is the clean essay fact.

5. used to / would

- *used to + base*: past habit or state, now finished. *The rupee used to be pegged.*
- *would + base*: past habit of **action**, not state. *Every summer the canal would run dry.* Not: *The rupee would be pegged.* (state → *used to*)

Do not confuse with *be used to + -ing* (Session 3).

6. Inserting history inside a present argument (essay craft)

CSS essays live in the **present** (what should be done now) but borrow **past** evidence.

Pattern:

1. Present claim.
2. Past illustration (2–3 sentences, one time frame).
3. Present link (*This episode still matters because...*).

Example:

- *Independent statistics are a condition of adult government. In 2010 the flood losses were guessed in public because the data systems had not been funded. That guesswork still haunts budget credibility today.*

Notice: the middle is past; the first and last are present. That is **controlled** mixing, not chaos.

7. Passive in the past (preview of Session 10)

- *The Act was passed in 2010.*
 - *The Act had been passed before the flood.*
- Do not write *The Act was passed in 2010 by the Parliament was...* Keep one finite verb cluster per clause.

Urdu-interference box

Don't	Do
<i>He did not went.</i>	<i>He did not go.</i>
<i>He had went.</i>	<i>He had gone.</i>
<i>She was failed in CSS.</i>	<i>She failed CSS. (or She was failed by a weak essay — only if you truly mean passive)</i>
<i>Yesterday I have met him.</i>	<i>Yesterday I met him.</i>
<i>In 1947 Pakistan has become independent.</i>	<i>In 1947 Pakistan became independent.</i>

Class drill

A. Choose

1. In 1973 Pakistan (adopts / adopted / has adopted / had adopted) a new constitution.
2. By 1973 the assembly (debated / had debated) the draft for years.
3. While the House (debated / was debating) the clause, a walk-out began.
4. After the 18th Amendment (passed / had passed / was passing), several ministries (moved / had moved) to the provinces. (Write the most natural pair.)
5. She (used to / was used to) write a page daily when she was a student.

B. Repair

6. He did not wrote the outline.
7. The policy had failed in 2019. (only one past time given)
8. They had built the dam last year.
9. I was knowing the result yesterday.

10. Pakistan is testing devices in 1998.

C. Timeline — put the verbs in the right past form.

Events: (i) drought lasts two years (ii) crop fails (iii) cabinet meets.

11. When the cabinet met, the crop ____ (fail) because a drought ____ (last) two years.

Essay-transfer task

Thesis (present): **Energy policy needs independence from daily politics.**

Write **150 words** in three stacked blocks, labelled:

- **A. Claim** (3–4 sentences, present system)
- **B. Illustration** (3 sentences, past system, include one year or one named episode: circular debt, load-shedding years, a specific plant delay — keep it modest and factual in tone)
- **C. Link** (2 sentences, back to present perfect or present simple)

Underline every verb. In the margin write *pres* or *past*.

Homework

1. Irregular list: write past simple + past participle of 25 CSS-useful verbs (including *rise/raise, lie/lay, seek, bind, lead, spend*).
 2. 8 sentences of past perfect that actually need it (two past times).
 3. 80 words: a historical illustration for *Federalism in Pakistan is unfinished business* — past tense only, then one present link sentence.
 4. Error log.
-

Exit ticket

1. When is past perfect necessary?
 2. Correct: *He did not went to the centre.*
 3. *used to* vs *be used to* — one sentence each.
 4. Why is *Pakistan had got independence in 1947* poor CSS English?
-

Teacher mark pointers

- Item 1: *adopted*.
- Item 7: *The policy failed in 2019* (drop *had*).
- Item 11: *had failed* + *had lasted* (both earlier than *met*), or *failed* + *had lasted*. Accept *had failed* / *had lasted*.
- Transfer: if block B leaks into present, mark T. If block A is entirely past, the thesis died — mark T.

Session 8 — Tenses III: Future, Mixed Tenses, Sequence

Module B • Time, voice, narration

Duration: 90 minutes

Exam link: policy recommendations (*will / going to / must*); sequence of tenses; *if I will*

Outcomes

The student can:

1. Form future meaning with *will*, *going to*, *present simple*, *present continuous*, *future perfect*.
2. Keep **sequence of tenses** when a past reporting verb governs a clause.
3. Mix tenses **on purpose** (present claim + past proof + future result).
4. Avoid *If it will rain* and *I will inform you when he will come*.
5. Write a closing paragraph of recommendations that is forceful but grammatically legal.

Teacher plan (90 minutes)

Time	Move
0–8	Recap past perfect: one board sentence with two pasts.
8–30	Future forms table. Time clauses with <i>when/if/until/as soon as</i> take present , not <i>will</i> . Sequence of tenses chart.
30–50	Repair + choose-the-future.
50–75	Transfer: 160-word mini-argument on <i>If Pakistan does not meter water, cities will run dry</i> — type-1 feel, controlled mix: present problem, past hint, future result, <i>must</i> recommendation.
75–85	Strip illegal <i>will</i> from time clauses in student work.
85–90	Homework, exit.

Traps: *shall* overuse (*I shall say that...*); *will* in *if*-clauses; future continuous everywhere; sequence ignored after *said that*.

Stretch: future perfect: *By 2030 the aquifer will have dropped below pumping cost*.

Student notes

1. English has no single “future tense”

We **express** the future in several ways. CSS needs three of them daily.

Form	Pattern	Use in an essay
will + base	<i>will fail</i>	prediction; result of a policy; spontaneous decision (rare in essays)
be going to	<i>is going to fail</i>	evidence-based near future; already decided trajectory
present simple	<i>fails / the House meets on Monday</i>	timetabled event; and all if/when clauses
present continuous	<i>is meeting the IMF team tomorrow</i>	fixed personal/institutional arrangement
future continuous	<i>will be debating</i>	action in progress at a future point (rare)
future perfect	<i>will have failed</i>	completed before a future deadline: <i>by 2030</i>
modal future	<i>must, should, may, could</i>	recommendation and hedge (often better than <i>will</i>)

CSS close: prefer **must** / **should** for what the state is obliged to do, and **will** for the likely consequence.

- *Pakistan must meter agricultural water. If it does not, cities will buy tankers at political prices.*

2. No *will* after *if* / *when* / *as soon as* / *until* / *before* / *after* / *unless* (time/condition clauses)

The **subordinate** clause takes present (or present perfect). The **main** clause may take *will*.

Wrong	Right
If the monsoon will fail, prices will rise.	If the monsoon fails , prices will rise.
I will write when the report will come.	I will write when the report comes .
Until the House will sit, the bill will wait.	Until the House sits , the bill will wait.
If she will study, she passes.	If she studies , she will pass.

Exception (advanced, optional): *if you will* = *if you are willing*. Too spoken for CSS. Skip it.

3. Sequence of tenses (the chain)

When the **main verb is past**, the next clause usually moves one step back. This is the same engine as narration (Session 11).

Direct / original	After a past main verb
<i>is</i>	<i>was</i>
<i>are</i>	<i>were</i>
<i>has/have</i>	<i>had</i>
<i>does / present simple</i>	<i>did / past simple</i>
<i>will</i>	<i>would</i>
<i>can</i>	<i>could</i>
<i>may</i>	<i>might</i>

Direct / original	After a past main verb
<i>must</i>	<i>must</i> or <i>had to</i> (meaning decides)

- *The minister says that the debt is stable.* (both present — he says it now)
- *The minister said that the debt was stable.* (he said it then)

Do not backshift if the statement is still timelessly true and you want to mark it as still true:

- *The teacher said that water boils at 100°C.*
- *The report said that the Constitution guarantees dignity.* (still in force)

In CSS, for **dated claims**, backshift. For **law and nature**, present is defensible. Be consistent inside the paragraph.

4. Controlled mixing — the adult paragraph

A high-scoring paragraph often walks through time **once**, in order:

1. **Present** — the problem as it stands
2. **Present perfect** — how long it has lasted
3. **Past** — one illustration
4. **Future / modal** — what follows if nothing changes, and what must be done

That is four tenses, one logic. Random hopping is the fault. Planned walking is style.

5. shall

British legal English uses *shall* for obligation in statutes. In a CSS essay, *shall* sounds theatrical (*I shall now discuss*). Use *will* for prediction and *must* for obligation.

Urdu-interference box

Urdu future (*ga / gi / ge*) appears in both clauses. English does not.

- *Agar barish hogi to rate barh jayega* → not *If it will rain...* → *If it rains, the rate will rise.*
- *Jab woh ayege main batata hoon* → *When he comes, I will tell you.* / *When he comes, I will let you know.*

Class drill

A. Repair the illegal *will*

1. If the census will slip again, the NFC will be blind.
2. The bank will act when the inflation will peak.
3. Unless the provinces will cooperate, the dam will stall.
4. As soon as the House will pass the bill, the ministry will notify it.

B. Sequence

5. He said that the policy (is / was) a mistake. (reporting a past interview)
6. The Constitution said nothing of the sort; it (guarantees / guaranteed) dignity — choose and justify.
7. She promised that she (will / would) publish the figures.

8. Scientists have shown that ice (melts / melted) at 0°C.

C. Future form

9. By 2030, if nothing changes, several cities (will run / will have run) out of cheap groundwater. (deadline completed)

10. The committee (meets / will meeting / is going to meets) on Monday; the notice is already out. (timetable)

Essay-transfer task

Prompt: **If Pakistan does not meter agricultural water, cities will run dry.**

Write **160 words** in four labelled beats:

1. Present problem (simple + continuous as needed)
2. Present perfect duration (*since/for*)
3. One past illustration (a year or a city)
4. Future consequence + *must/should* recommendation

Ban: *if... will* in the *if*-clause; *shall I say*; *need of the hour*.

Homework

1. Write 8 legal *if/when/until* sentences with *will* only in the main clause.
2. Convert: *The minister says, "The circular debt is falling."* into past reporting with backshift, then into a version that keeps present because you believe the claim is still true. Note the difference.
3. 100-word closing paragraph of recommendations on *urban flooding* using *must* twice, *should* once, *will* once, *may* once.
4. Error log.

Exit ticket

1. Why is *If it will rain, we will cancel* wrong?
2. *said that she will come* — repair.
3. Which form: completed before 2030?
4. Name the four beats of a controlled mixed-tense paragraph.

Teacher mark pointers

- 6: accept *guarantees* with a one-line justification (still in force). *guaranteed* is also possible if treating the text as a historical act — ask the student to be consistent.
- 9: *will have run*.
- 10: *meets* (timetable) or *is meeting* (arrangement). Not *will meeting*.
- Transfer beat 4 without a named actor (*the provinces, IRSA, WAPDA, municipal governments*) is a content-empty pass — push for an actor even in grammar class.

Session 9 — Agreement and Sentence Architecture

Module B • Time, voice, narration

Duration: 90 minutes

Exam link: sentence correction (highest-yield family); long CSS sentences that lose the verb

Outcomes

The student can:

1. Find the **head noun** and make the verb agree, even when phrases intervene.
2. Apply special patterns: *each/every*, *either/or*, *neither/nor*, *many a*, *one of*, *as well as*, *with*, *along with*.
3. Keep lists **parallel**.
4. Control sentence length: 12–28 words as the CSS comfort zone.
5. Repair a 40-word wreck without changing the writer's meaning.

Teacher plan (90 minutes)

Time	Move
0–8	Recap sequence: <i>said that</i> + <i>would</i> .
8–28	SVA map. Distance subjects. Nearer-subject rule. Collective nouns (BrE). Parallelism.
28–50	12 exam-style corrections. Students must name the head noun before they write the verb.
50–72	Transfer: one complex sentence (max 28 words) + one compound + one simple on <i>The quality of governance, not the quantity of ministries, decides service delivery</i> . Then expand to 120 words without breaking agreement.
72–85	Mid-course warning: next session starts with the 50-mark test or assign the test as homework tonight / first 25 min of Session 10. (See assessments.)
85–90	Homework, exit.

Traps: verb agreeing with the nearest noun; *the people is*; *many a students*; *as well as* treated like *and*.

Stretch: *none of* + uncountable singular / + plural countable — both seen; teach *None of the evidence is*; **None of the reports ***are/is*** — FPSC often wants *is* with *none*. This course: *none of the evidence is*; *none of the ministers has*** (exam-safe singular).

Student notes

1. Agreement is a hunt for the subject

The verb agrees with the **subject**, not with a noun that happens to sit next to the verb.

- *The quality of the apples is poor.*

- *The risks in the energy sector are political.*
- *A list of demands has been sent.*

Cross out prepositional phrases with a pencil: *of the apples, in the energy sector, of demands*. What is left is the subject.

2. Singular by rule, even when they “feel” plural

Trigger	Verb	Example
<i>each, every, everyone, everybody, someone, nobody, anyone</i>	singular	<i>Each of the provinces has a grievance.</i>
<i>one, another, either, neither</i> (as pronouns)	singular	<i>Neither is ready.</i>
<i>much, little, a little</i>	singular	<i>Little has been done.</i>
<i>many a + singular noun</i>	singular	<i>Many a reformer has quit.</i>
time, money, distance as a lump	singular	<i>Ten years is a long delay. / Five billion rupees was spent.</i>
the number of	singular	<i>The number of voters is rising.</i>
uncountable	singular	<i>The news is bad. Progress is slow.</i>

3. Plural by rule

Trigger	Verb	Example
<i>a number of, a group of</i> (often)	plural	<i>A number of files are missing.</i>
<i>few, many, several, both</i>	plural	<i>Few are willing.</i>
<i>the police</i> (BrE), <i>the poor, the British</i>	plural	<i>The police are investigating.</i>
<i>people</i> (human beings)	plural	<i>The people are ahead of the elite.</i>
nouns like <i>scissors, riches, thanks</i>	plural	<i>His thanks were brief.</i>

Peoples = nations: *the peoples of South Asia*. Ordinary citizens = *people*.

4. either...or / neither...nor — nearer subject

The verb follows the subject **closest to it**.

- *Neither the ministers nor the PM is willing.*
- *Neither the PM nor the ministers are willing.*
- *Either the data or the testimony is false.*
- *Either the testimony or the data are false.* (if you treat *data* as plural)

In an essay, if the pair looks ugly, recast: *The PM and the ministers are unwilling.*

5. and vs as well as / along with / together with / in addition to / with

- X **and** Y → usually **plural**: *The secretary and the minister have signed.*
- X **as well as** Y → verb follows **X**: *The secretary as well as the minister has signed.*
- If X and Y are one idea: *Bread and butter is her breakfast.* Rare in CSS; don't force it.

Two titles, one person: *The secretary and spokesman has arrived* (one human). Two people: *The secretary and the spokesman have arrived.*

6. Relative clauses

The verb in *who/that/which* agrees with the **noun described**.

- *It is I who am responsible.* (grammatically pure; in CSS recast: *I am responsible.*)
- *He is one of the officers who have signed.* (*who* → officers)
- *He is the only one of the officers who has signed.* (*who* → the only one)

This pair is an FPSC favourite.

7. Parallelism (architecture)

When you list, keep the same grammatical shape.

- *The state must tax, spend and explain.*
- Not: *tax, spending and the explanation of policy.*
- *not only a failure of law but also a failure of nerve***
- *both to audit and to publish***

Broken parallelism is a structure fault (code S).

8. Length and architecture for CSS

A readable essay sentence is often **12–28 words**. Past 35, agreement dies and so does the examiner.

Tools to shorten:

1. split with a full stop
2. kill *It is important to note that*
3. turn a relative clause into an adjective: *the delayed census*
4. one idea per sentence; extra idea → extra sentence

Wreck: *The quality of the reforms which were introduced by the ministry in a hurry after the flood and without consultation of the provinces are doubtful.*

Head noun: *quality* → **is**. Then split: *The ministry introduced hurried reforms after the flood without consulting the provinces. Their quality is doubtful.*

| Urdu-interference box

Urdu verbs often agree with the nearest noun or with a plural sense of *log*.

- *Aik bunyadi wajohat yeh hain* → *One of the basic reasons is***
- *Hukumat ke iqdamat nakam hai* → *The government's measures have failed.* (measures = plural)

Class drill

Name the **head subject** first, then the verb.

1. The quality of these reports (is / are) uneven.
 2. Each of the secretaries (has / have) a veto.
 3. Many a candidate (fail / fails) because of grammar.
 4. The secretary as well as the aides (was / were) late.
 5. Neither the notes nor the outline (was / were) ready.
 6. Neither the outline nor the notes (was / were) ready.
 7. He is one of those writers who (revises / revise) daily.
 8. He is the only one of those writers who (revises / revise) daily.
 9. Five years (is / are) a long time to wait for a census.
 10. A number of amendments (has / have) been dropped.
 11. The number of amendments (has / have) been dropped.
 12. Repair parallelism: *The commission was asked to examine the files, interviewing witnesses and a report.*
-

Essay-transfer task

Stem: **The quality of governance, not the quantity of ministries, decides service delivery.**

1. Write the stem as a **simple** sentence (you may keep it almost as is).
2. Write a **compound** sentence (two independents) that agrees throughout.
3. Write a **complex** sentence (max 28 words) with *although* or *because*.
4. Expand into **120 words**. After writing, circle every subject and every verb. Draw a line from subject to verb.

If any pair disagrees, repair before you hand in.

Homework

1. Complete `assessments/02-mid-course-test.md` under 40 minutes if the teacher has not already timed it in class.
 2. Write 10 SVA sentences using: *one of, many a, as well as, neither/nor, a number of, the number of, each, the poor, ten billion rupees, people*.
 3. Take one paragraph from your old notes and shorten every sentence over 30 words.
 4. Error log: agreement only, five entries.
-

Exit ticket

1. Why is *The quality of the reforms are poor* wrong?
 2. *Many a* takes singular or plural noun?
 3. Nearer-subject rule applies to which pair of correlatives?
 4. Repair: *not only corrupt but also a failure of design* (make parallel).
-

| Teacher mark pointers

- 7: *revise* (who = writers). 8: *revises* (who = the only one).
- 9: *is*. 10: *have*. 11: *has*.
- 12: *to examine the files, to interview witnesses and to write a report*.
- Mid-test: mark with the four codes plus a 50-mark scheme in the answer-key file. Do not skip feedback; Session 10 assumes SVA is in place.

Session 10 — Active and Passive Voice

Module B • Time, voice, narration

Duration: 90 minutes

Exam link: voice conversion (older papers); essay style — agency vs anonymity

Outcomes

The student can:

1. Convert a sentence from active to passive and back **without changing tense**.
2. Form passive with modals (*must be taxed*), perfect (*has been taxed*), and continuous (*is being taxed*).
3. Choose voice **on purpose**: active for argument and blame; passive for process, law, or unknown actor.
4. Avoid empty passives (*steps should be taken*) and illegal passives of intransitive verbs.
5. Rewrite a bureaucratic paragraph into adult CSS English.

Teacher plan (90 minutes)

Time	Move
0–25	If the mid-test was not sat, sit the first 20 minutes now. Else recap SVA with two board items.
25–45	Voice formula. Tense-by-tense table. When CSS wants passive vs active.
45–65	Conversion drill both ways. Kill <i>is happened</i> , <i>was died</i> , <i>was failed</i> (wrong).
65–82	Transfer: two versions of a 100-word paragraph on <i>Who should be taxed?</i> — (A) mostly active, named actors (B) mostly passive. Students judge which paragraph a CSS examiner would trust, and why.
82–90	Homework, exit.

Traps: changing tense while converting; *by* stuffed onto every passive; passive of *happen*, *occur*, *die*, *consist*, *resemble*; *It is being rained*.

Stretch: double-object passives: *The poor were denied a hearing* / *A hearing was denied to the poor*.

Student notes

1. Voice is about who is in the spotlight

- **Active:** the **doer** is the subject. *Parliament passed the bill*.
- **Passive:** the **receiver** is the subject. *The bill was passed (by Parliament)*.

Both are grammatical. CSS essays that hide every doer sound like a timid press release. CSS essays that never use passive cannot describe a process. You need **both**, on purpose.

2. The conversion formula

Active: **Doer + verb + object**

Passive: **Object + be (same tense) + past participle + (by + doer)**

The object of the active sentence **must exist**. No object → no ordinary passive.

- *The monsoon arrived.* (intransitive) → no *The monsoon was arrived.*
- *The crop failed.* → not *The crop was failed* (unless someone failed it).

3. be carries the tense

Tense	Active	Passive
Present simple	<i>The FBR taxes retailers.</i>	<i>Retailers are taxed (by the FBR).</i>
Present continuous	<i>The FBR is taxing retailers.</i>	<i>Retailers are being taxed.</i>
Present perfect	<i>The FBR has taxed retailers.</i>	<i>Retailers have been taxed.</i>
Past simple	<i>The FBR taxed retailers.</i>	<i>Retailers were taxed.</i>
Past continuous	<i>The FBR was taxing retailers.</i>	<i>Retailers were being taxed.</i>
Past perfect	<i>The FBR had taxed retailers.</i>	<i>Retailers had been taxed.</i>
Future	<i>The FBR will tax retailers.</i>	<i>Retailers will be taxed.</i>
Modal	<i>The FBR must tax retailers.</i>	<i>Retailers must be taxed.</i>
going to	<i>The FBR is going to tax retailers.</i>	<i>Retailers are going to be taxed.</i>

There is normally **no** present/past perfect continuous passive in student writing (*has been being taxed*). Recast.

4. When CSS should use passive

1. Actor unknown: *The file was leaked.*
2. Actor obvious or irrelevant: *The accused was sentenced to two years.*
3. Process / science / law: *The bill was referred to committee.*
4. You want to emphasise the victim or the object: *The witnesses were intimidated.*

5. When CSS should use active

1. Argument and blame: *The cabinet delayed the census.*
2. Recommendations: *The Election Commission should publish the rolls.*
3. Clarity: if the passive needs a long *by*-phrase, flip it.

Empty passive (ban): *Concrete steps should be taken. It is hoped that things will improve. It is to be noted that...*

Named active (prefer): *The Ministry of Finance should publish the true circular debt this quarter.*

6. Verbs that resist ordinary passive

happen, occur, take place, appear, seem, belong, consist, resemble, lack, die, fall (the weather), *rise*.

- *An accident happened.* not *was happened*
- *The meeting took place.* not *was took place*
- *He died in 2020.* not *was died*

agree: *The committee agreed.* / *It was agreed that...* (impersonal, legal). Not *The committee was agreed* unless *agreed* is an adjective: *They were agreed on a draft* — possible, but *had agreed* is safer.

7. get-passive

got arrested, got promoted — spoken. CSS: *was arrested, was promoted*.

8. By-agent: often drop it

If the doer is *someone, people, the authorities* — omit.

If the doer is the point of the sentence — keep, or switch to active.

- Weak: *The law was passed by the Parliament of Pakistan in the year 2010.*
- Stronger: *Parliament passed the law in 2010.*

Urdu-interference box

Urdu *hua / gayi / diya gaya* tempts students to paste *was/were* onto every verb.

- *Accident ho gaya* → *An accident happened.* not *was happened*
- *Wo CSS mein fail ho gaya* → *He failed CSS.* not *He was failed in CSS.*
- *Faisla kiya gaya* → *A decision was taken* is legal but empty. *The cabinet decided...*

Class drill

A. Convert to passive. Keep the tense. Drop *by* if the doer is obvious.

1. The Supreme Court struck down the ordinance.
2. The ministry is drafting a new framework.
3. The provinces have not implemented the order.
4. WAPDA must meter the tube wells.
5. Someone leaked the paper.

B. Convert to active. Invent a precise doer if needed.

6. It is hoped that inflation will fall.
7. Concrete steps should be taken to improve education.
8. The census was delayed.
9. A decision was taken to subsidise electricity.

C. Repair

10. The accident was happened on the motorway.
11. She was died of dengue.
12. The bill is being pass tomorrow.
13. The poor is ignored by policy.
14. The meeting was taken place at dawn.

Essay-transfer task

Question: **Who should be taxed more fairly — retailers, real estate, or the salaried class? (You may pick one line.)**

Write **two** 90–100 word paragraphs.

- **Paragraph A — active:** almost every sentence names a doer (FBR, Parliament, provincial boards, the salaried class).
- **Paragraph B — passive:** describe the same policy as a process.

Then write **four lines** answering: Which paragraph is more honest? Where was passive actually better? Copy one sentence you would keep in a real CSS essay.

Homework

1. Convert 10 active sentences of your own (education theme) into passive, then three of them back. Tick tense: it must not change.
 2. Rewrite this press-release into CSS English (mostly active, 80 words): *It is high time that steps should be taken by the authorities concerned so that the problem of urban flooding may be addressed and it is hoped that the masses will be facilitated in the near future.*
 3. Error log: every empty passive you find in your old essays.
 4. Preview: bring a short quoted sentence (a headline or a one-line report) for Session 11.
-

Exit ticket

1. Write the passive formula.
 2. Why is *was happened* wrong?
 3. Passive of *must meter the wells*.
 4. Give one good reason to use passive in a CSS essay.
-

Teacher mark pointers

- 5: *The paper was leaked.* (by someone is dead weight.)
- 6: *Economists / the government / this essay hopes...* — force a doer. *I hope* is weak in CSS; *Inflation may fall if...* is better.
- 13: *The poor are ignored* (adjective-as-noun = plural) even in passive.
- Homework 2: a good recast names *city governments, drains, housing on floodplains*. Reward agency.

Session 11 — Narration: Direct and Indirect Speech

Module B • Time, voice, narration

Duration: 90 minutes

Exam link: narration items in older papers; quoting reports and thinkers in the essay without tense collapse

Outcomes

The student can:

1. Convert statements, questions, and commands from **direct** to **indirect** speech.
2. Apply **backshift** when the reporting verb is past, and know when not to.
3. Change pronouns, time/place words, and question order.
4. Choose a precise **reporting verb** (*argued, warned, conceded, estimated*).
5. Embed one short quotation in a CSS paragraph without turning the paragraph into a scrapbook.

Teacher plan (90 minutes)

Time	Move
0–8	Recap voice: empty vs named. One student press-release recast on the board.
8–30	Four changes: pronoun, tense, time/place, joiner. Statement / question / command columns.
30–52	Conversion drill. Include <i>said me, where did he live</i> in indirect, and a universal-truth no-backshift.
52–78	Transfer: paragraph on <i>Climate reports are not optional reading for the state</i> . Students must (i) one direct short quote, correctly punctuated (ii) one indirect report of a finding (iii) their own present-tense claim.
78–86	Public correction of question-order faults.
86–90	Homework, exit.

Traps: *said me*; keeping the question mark in indirect; *He asked that what*; no backshift after *said*; quoting three poets in 100 words.

Stretch: reporting verbs of argument: *allege, concede, refute, contend, testify*.

Student notes

1. Why a CSS essay needs narration

You will mention a report, a judgment, a speech, or a writer. You have two honest tools:

- **Direct speech:** the exact words, in quotation marks. Use **rarely**, and only when the wording itself matters.
- **Indirect speech (narration):** you report the meaning as a *that*-clause. This is the default in academic essays.

A CSS script stuffed with boxed quotes looks like a cram academy product. One well-framed line is enough.

2. The reporting frame

- *say + that* (no personal object required): *The minister said that the debt was falling.*
- *tell + object + that*: *The minister told the House that the debt was falling.*
- *Never: said me / said the House that.*
- *said to the House that* is possible; *told the House* is cleaner.

Choose a verb that already contains your attitude:

Neutral	Sharper
said, told, stated	warned, admitted, claimed, alleged, estimated, insisted, denied, urged, conceded

The IMF warned that reserves were thin is stronger than *The IMF said that...*

3. Four changes (when the reporting verb is past)

(i) Pronouns

Shift so they match the reporter's world.

- He said, "**I** have **my** file." → He said that **he** had **his** file.

(ii) Tense backshift

Direct	Indirect
am / is	was
are	were
have / has	had
present simple	past simple
present continuous	past continuous
present perfect	past perfect
past simple	past perfect
past perfect	past perfect (no further back)
will	would
can	could
may	might
must	must / had to
shall (I/we)	would

(iii) Time and place

Direct	Indirect
now	then

Direct	Indirect
today	that day
tonight	that night
yesterday	the previous day / the day before
tomorrow	the next day / the following day
last week	the previous week
next week	the following week
ago	before
here	there
this / these	that / those

If the report is written **on the same day** and the words are still live, some markers stay. In classroom keys, apply the table unless the stem says “same day”.

(iv) Joiners and punctuation

Drop quotation marks. Drop the question mark and the exclamation mark in indirect speech.

- Statement: *that*
- Yes/no question: *if / whether*
- Wh-question: keep *what / why / how / where / when / who*
- Command: *to + verb / not to + verb*

4. Questions: statement word order

This is the item students lose.

Direct: *He said, “Where does the secretary live?”*

Indirect: *He asked where the secretary lived.*

Not: *He asked where did the secretary live.*

Not: *He asked that where the secretary lived.*

Direct: *She said, “Are you ready?”*

Indirect: *She asked if I was ready.*

5. Commands, requests, advice

- “Sit down.” → *He told me to sit down.*
- “Please wait.” → *He asked me to wait.*
- “Don’t leak the file.” → *He ordered me not to leak the file.*
- “You should publish it.” → *He advised me to publish it. / He said that I should publish it.*

6. When not to backshift

1. Reporting verb is **present / present perfect / future**: *The report says that the aquifer is falling.*
2. Universal truth or still-operative law (optional, if you want to mark it as still true): *He said that the Constitution guarantees dignity.*

3. Past simple with a **named date** sometimes stays: *He said that Pakistan tested devices in 1998.* (the date already locks the past)

7. Punctuating a rare direct quote in an essay

- *The World Bank noted, “Pakistan’s water economy is at a breaking point.”*
- Comma (or colon) before the quote. Capital inside if it is a full sentence. Source **before** or **immediately after**.
- After the quote, return to **your** present-tense argument. Do not let the quote’s tense infect the next three lines.

8. Never let narration become decoration

One report, one thinker, or one judgment per paragraph is enough. Then **your** analysis. Examiners have said quotations must be well placed and relevant.

Urdu-interference box

- *Us ne kaha ke kya tum tayyar ho* → not *He said that are you ready* → *He asked if I was ready.*
- *Us ne mujh se kaha* → *He told me*, not *said me*.
- *Poocha ke kahan rehta hai* → *asked where he lived*, not *asked that where does he live*.

Class drill

A. Indirect (reporting verb past)

1. She said, “I am drafting the rules.”
2. He said to me, “I completed the file yesterday.”
3. The minister said, “We will publish the debt.”
4. She said, “I can verify the names.”
5. He said, “Water boils at 100°C.” (keep the science true)

B. Questions and commands

6. He said, “Are the rolls ready?”
7. She said, “Where does the canal leak?”
8. The judge said, “Produce the record.”
9. The secretary said, “Do not brief the press.”
10. Repair: He asked that what was the delay.

C. Essay frame

11. Turn into one indirect sentence with a sharp verb: World Bank / “Pakistan’s water economy is at a breaking point.” (treat as a past report)

Essay-transfer task

Theme: **Climate reports are not optional reading for a state that lives on the monsoon.**

Write **140 words**.

Must include:

1. Your thesis in present simple.
2. **One** direct quotation (maximum 15 words, invented-for-practice or from a well-known public line — label it *practice quote* if invented). Correct punctuation.
3. **One** indirect sentence reporting a finding (*A 20xx assessment warned that...*).
4. Two sentences of **your** analysis in the present system.

If you cannot remember a real report, write *A national assessment warned that urban aquifers were falling* — honest generic reporting is better than a fake exact citation.

Homework

1. Convert 8 mixed items (3 statements, 3 questions, 2 commands) from a mixed list you write yourself about *education*.
 2. Punctuate: *the chief justice said the law will find you* — write both a legal direct version and an indirect version.
 3. 80 words: report a classroom debate using only **indirect** speech and three different reporting verbs.
 4. Error log: *said me*, question-order, missed backshift.
-

Exit ticket

1. *said* vs *told* — one line.
 2. Indirect: “Where do you live?” he asked me.
 3. Why drop the question mark in indirect speech?
 4. When do you refuse to backshift?
-

Teacher mark pointers

- 2: *He told me that he had completed the file the previous day.* (*said to me that* acceptable.)
- 5: *boils* preferred.
- 6: *He asked if/whether the rolls were ready.*
- 10: *He asked what the delay was.*
- 11: *The World Bank warned that Pakistan’s water economy was at a breaking point.* (past report) or *has warned that ... is* if you treat the report as still current — both defensible; the student must be consistent.
- Invented quotes in the transfer must be labelled if not real. We are teaching grammar, not fabricating sources for the real exam. Tell students: in the real CSS paper, only quote what you can actually attribute.

Session 12 — Conditionals and Hypothetical Policy

Module C • Accuracy and transfer

Duration: 90 minutes

Exam link: *if/unless/until* sentence correction; policy arguments (“If Pakistan invested...”)

Outcomes

The student can:

1. Form conditionals 0, 1, 2, 3 and one mixed type.
2. Use *were* in unreal present (*If I were*).
3. Avoid *unless...not*, *until...not*, and *if it will*.
4. Match the conditional to the essay job: law of nature, real policy, imagined reform, missed chance.
5. Write a 4-sentence policy ladder on one CSS theme.

Teacher plan (90 minutes)

Time	Move
0–8	Recap narration: one question converted on the board.
8–28	Four-box conditional wall. <i>unless/until</i> . Mixed: past cause, present result.
28–50	Form drills + FPSC-style <i>unless</i> items.
50–75	Transfer: <i>Education funding</i> — one sentence of each type 0–3, then a 120-word type-1/type-2 mixed paragraph of recommendations.
75–85	Kill <i>if I would</i> / <i>if it will</i> / <i>unless you don't</i> .
85–90	Homework, exit.

Traps: *If I would be the PM*; *If I will*; *would* in both clauses; *unless you don't*.

Stretch: inverted forms *Had the census been on time, ...* / *Were the rolls clean, ...* — academic and useful in a conclusion.

Student notes

1. A conditional is a deal between two clauses

- **If-clause** (condition)
- **Main clause** (result)

Tense pairing is fixed. Do not invent a fifth mix in a CSS paper.

2. The four working types

Type	If-clause	Main clause	Essay job
0 real, always	present	present	laws, definitions, mechanical results
1 real future	present	<i>will / can / may / must</i>	practical policy, likely result
2 unreal now	past (<i>were for be</i>)	<i>would / could / might + base</i>	imagining a different present
3 unreal past	<i>had + past participle</i>	<i>would have / could have / might have + PP</i>	missed chance, regret, historical counterfactual

Examples on one theme — water:

- 0: *If canal water is free at the margin, farmers flood the field.*
- 1: *If the provinces meter tube wells next year, urban tankers will lose their market.*
- 2: *If water were priced honestly, the crop mix would change.*
- 3: *If the aquifer had been metered in the 1990s, several cities would not have sunk their own wells.*

3. Type 2: *were*

For unreal present, *be* becomes *were* for all persons in careful English:

- *If I were the finance minister, I would publish the debt.*
- *If the federation were serious, the census would not slip.*

If I was is common in speech. CSS keys still like *were*. Use *were*.

4. Mixed conditional (very useful in essays)

Past condition → present result

- *If the census had been held on time, the NFC would be less toxic now.*

Pattern: *If + had + PP, would + base.*

5. *unless / until / as long as / provided that*

- **unless** = *if not*. Already negative. Do **not** add *not / never / don't*.
The bill will fail unless the treasury is present.
 Not: *unless the treasury is not present.*
- **until** = up to the time when. Use a **positive** verb for the event you wait for.
Wait until the House sits.
 Not: *until the House does not sit.*
 Negative result lives in the other clause: *The bill will not move until the House sits.*
- **as long as / provided that / providing that** = only if.
The IMF programme will hold provided that the tax take rises.
- **in case** = because perhaps. *Publish the rolls in case the court asks.* Not a synonym of *if* in every sentence.

6. Illegal doubles

Don't	Do
If I would be PM, I would...	If I were PM, I would...
If she would have studied, she would have passed	If she had studied, she would have passed
If it will rain...	If it rains ...
unless you don't	unless you
If the state would meter, prices will ...	mix is illegal; pick type 1 or 2

Both clauses of type 2 take the “unreal” pair (*past* + *would*). Both clauses of type 3 take the “unreal past” pair (*had* + *would have*). Do not put *would* in the *if*-clause (except the rare *if you would* = willingness — skip in CSS).

7. Inversion (optional polish)

- *Had the rolls been clean, the petition would have failed.*
- *Were the tax base broader, rates could be lower.*
- *Should the monsoon fail, food inflation will bite.* (type 1, formal)

Use **one** inverted conditional in a conclusion, not in every paragraph.

8. wish / as if / as though

- *I wish the census were honest.* (now)
- *I wish the census had been honest.* (past)
- *He speaks as if he were the regulator.* (unreal)
- *He speaks as if he knows the file.* (maybe he does)

FPSC has tested *as if he were mad*.

Urdu-interference box

- *Agar main PM hota* → *If I were PM*, not *If I would be PM*.
- *Agar us ne mehnat ki hoti* → *If she had worked*, not *If she would have worked*.
- *Jab tak wo nahi aata* in English is often *until he comes*, not *until he does not come*.

Class drill

A. Name the type and repair if needed.

1. If you heat ice, it melts.
2. If the FBR will document retailers, the deficit will shrink.
3. If I was you, I would rewrite the outline. (make it CSS-careful)
4. If the dam was completed in 1998, the 2010 flood would have been milder. (intended: missed past)
5. If she had published the figures, the debate would be saner now.

B. unless / until

6. The court will not sit unless the bar is not on strike.
7. Do not file until you do not have the annexures. (intended: wait until you have them)
8. Unless you study, you will not pass. (already correct? yes/no)

C. Write to order

9. Type 1: climate / Karachi drains.
 10. Type 3: a delayed census.
-

| Essay-transfer task

Theme: **Public education is the only scalable equaliser.**

Write **four standalone sentences**, labelled 0, 1, 2, 3, all on this theme.

Then write **120 words** that are **mostly type 1** (real policy) with **one** type-2 sentence (imagined present) and **one** mixed sentence (past failure → present pain).

Circle *if / unless / until / were / had*.

| Homework

1. 12 sentences: 3 of each type, two themes (gender justice, tax).
 2. Invert two type-3 sentences (*Had...*).
 3. Repair 8 *unless/until/if will* items from a list you create by deliberately writing them wrong first, then correcting.
 4. Error log.
-

| Exit ticket

1. Write the type-2 formula.
 2. Repair: *If I would have known...*
 3. Why is *unless you don't go* wrong?
 4. Mixed conditional: past cause, present result — one sentence on the census.
-

| Teacher mark pointers

- 2: *If the FBR documents...* (drop *will*).
- 3: *If I were you...*
- 4: *If the dam had been completed in 1998, the 2010 flood would have been milder.*
- 5 is mixed and already good.
- 6: drop the extra *not*: *unless the bar is on strike.*
- 7: *until you have the annexures.*
- 8: yes, correct.

Session 13 — Punctuation and Sentence Polish

Module C • Accuracy and transfer

Duration: 90 minutes

Exam link: 2–3 punctuation items in sentence correction; readability of the essay

Outcomes

The student can:

1. Use the **full stop, comma, semicolon, colon, apostrophe, quotation marks, hyphen, dash, question mark**.
2. Identify and kill the **comma splice**.
3. Punctuate *however, therefore, for example* correctly.
4. Control *its / it's, Pakistan's, 1990s, MPs*.
5. Punctuate a short dialogue-free academic paragraph and a single quotation.

Teacher plan (90 minutes)

Time	Move
0–8	Recap <i>If I were / had + would have</i> .
8–28	Marks one by one, 90 seconds each, with a CSS example. Comma splice as enemy #1.
28–50	Unpunctuated paragraph + 8 exam-style punctuation repairs.
50–75	Transfer: punctuate a dirty 160-word essay opening on <i>A free press</i> ; then rewrite two splices as (a) two sentences (b) semicolon (c) <i>because</i> .
75–85	Apostrophe clinic: <i>its, 2000s, officers' hostel, FBR's</i> .
85–90	Homework, exit.

Traps: comma after *although* clause missing (minor) vs comma splice (major); *however* as a conjunction; *it's* in an essay; colon vs semicolon mix-up.

Stretch: paired dashes for an interruption; no space before semicolon/colon in standard BrE typing.

Student notes

1. Punctuation is grammar you can hear

If you would take a full breath, you probably need a **full stop**, not a comma.

FPSC often puts 2–3 punctuation-only items in sentence correction. They also silently punish punctuation in the essay because it is “flawed language.”

2. Full stop (.)

Ends a statement. CSS default. When in doubt, stop.

3. Comma (,)

Use a comma:

1. After a front dependent clause: *Although the law exists, it is unenforced.*
2. Before a coordinator joining two **full** sentences: *The law exists, but it is unenforced.*
3. In a list: *tax, spend and explain* (BrE often skips the extra comma before *and*; a serial comma is not a fault).
4. Around extra information: *The 18th Amendment, which recast the federation, still lacks a fiscal follow-through.*
5. After a sentence adverb: *However, the rolls are dirty.*
6. In numbers (BrE): *1,000,000*
7. With a reporting frame: *The court held, “The right is not absolute.”*

Do **not** use a comma:

- to join two full sentences (**comma splice**)
- after *that* in *He said that the bill had failed.*
- between subject and verb: *The quality of the reforms, is poor.*

Comma splice (illegal):

Inflation is high, the poor suffer.

Legal repairs:

- *Inflation is high. The poor suffer.*
- *Inflation is high; the poor suffer.*
- *Inflation is high, and the poor suffer.*
- *Inflation is high because the poor’s food basket is import-heavy.* (recast)

4. Semicolon (;)

Joins two **related complete** sentences without a coordinator.

- *The law exists; enforcement does not.*

Also separates messy list items that already contain commas.

Do not use a semicolon before *and/but* in ordinary student writing. Do not use it after *although*.

5. Colon (:)

Introduces an explanation, a list, or a quotation after a **complete** lead-in.

- *The state faces a simple test: can it tax its friends?*
- *Three files are missing: the annexure, the minutes and the dissenting note.*

Wrong: *The state faces: inflation and debt.* (the lead-in is not complete)

6. Apostrophe (')

Job	Example
Possession, singular	<i>Pakistan's economy, the court's order</i>
Possession, plural already ending in s	<i>the provinces' demand, the officers' hostel</i>
Irregular plural	<i>the children's share, the people's house</i>
Contractions	<i>it's = it is</i> — avoid contractions in CSS essays
Missing letters	<i>don't use gov't</i>

its = possessive of *it* (no apostrophe): *The state lost its nerve.*

it's = it is. Do not write *it's* in the essay. Write *it is* or recast.

Decades: *the 1990s* (no apostrophe). Not *1990's* unless you mean *the 1990's budget* (awkward — write *the 1990 budget*).

Abbreviations: *MPs, NGOs* (plural, no apostrophe). *the MP's question* (one MP, possessive).

7. Quotation marks

British school style often uses **single** quotes; many Pakistani papers use **double**. This course uses **double** for CSS scripts because they scan clearly in handwritten papers.

- One short quote, source attached.
- Comma/colon before a full-sentence quote.
- Full stop **inside** if the quote is a full sentence: *He said, "The debt is structural."*

8. Hyphen vs dash

- **Hyphen** (-) builds one adjective: *a long-term risk, a well-known judgment, a three-year delay.*
- **Dash** (—) (in handwriting, two hyphens or a long stroke) marks a break: *The census — delayed again — has poisoned the NFC.* Use rarely.

9. Question mark and exclamation

Ask a real question: *Can a state that fears data claim adult government?*

Do not pepper the essay with rhetorical questions. **No exclamation marks** in CSS essays.

10. however, therefore, moreover, for example

These are **not** FANBOYS. They cannot splice.

Wrong: *The law exists, however it is dead.*

Right: *The law exists. However, it is dead. / The law exists; however, it is dead. / The law exists but is dead.*

Urdu-interference box

Urdu punctuation is lighter. Students produce English “and-and-and” chains with commas:

- *Pakistan is an agricultural country, most people live in villages, they have no hospitals, the youth is frustrated.*
Four sentences. Put stops. Then keep **one** link: *Pakistan remains largely agrarian. Most villagers still lack a functioning hospital, and frustrated youth leave for the city.*

Class drill

A. Repair only punctuation (smallest change).

1. Inflation is high, the poor suffer.
2. The law exists, however it is unenforced.
3. Although the rolls are dirty the petition failed.
4. The state faces: debt inflation and a thin tax base.
5. Its a long delay in the census.
6. The 1990's were kinder to the rupee.
7. The officers hostel is full. (more than one officer)
8. Can a fearful state claim adult government.

B. Choose semicolon or colon.

9. The test is simple ____ tax your friends.
10. The test is simple ____ the state still fails it.

C. Unpunctuated block — punctuate without rewriting words:

11. although the 18th amendment recast the federation fiscal follow through remains weak the provinces demand money they do not always build capacity however the answer is not to reverse devolution it is to audit it

Essay-transfer task

Dirty opening (copy, then punctuate, then polish two splices in three legal ways):

a free press is not a luxury it is a checking institution the state often treats journalists as a nuisance however a state that cannot bear news cannot bear citizens the constitution names expression as a right the practice names it as a risk

Then continue with **80 words of your own**, fully punctuated, no contractions, one optional colon, no exclamation.

Homework

1. Copy ten sentences from Dawn. Mark every punctuation. Note one you would have got wrong.
2. Write 8 comma-splice repairs, each splice repaired **three** ways (stop / semicolon / conjunction).
3. Apostrophe sheet: 12 possessives including *its*, *people's*, *provinces'*, *FBR's*, *2000s*.
4. Error log.

Exit ticket

1. Three legal repairs of a comma splice.
2. *its* vs *it's*.
3. Why can't *however* do the job of *but*?
4. Punctuate: *the court held the right is not absolute* (as a quotation).

Teacher mark pointers

- 3: comma after *dirty* is preferred.
- 4: *The state faces three shocks: debt, inflation and a thin tax base.* (may add *three shocks* to make the lead-in complete) or recast without colon. Smallest change: *The state faces debt, inflation and a thin tax base.*
- 5: *It's* → *It is* / *Its* is wrong here because it means *it is*.
- 6: *The 1990s.*
- 7: *The officers' hostel.*
- 9: colon. 10: semicolon.
- Reward students who use fewer marks correctly rather than more marks fashionably.

Session 14 — Removing Errors I (FPSC Families)

Module C • Accuracy and transfer

Duration: 90 minutes

Exam link: Precis paper sentence correction (10 marks) + silent essay language marks

Outcomes

The student can:

1. Name the FPSC instruction: **smallest needed correction only**.
2. Diagnose five families: **agreement, articles, prepositions, tense/time, unless-until-if**.
3. Rewrite a faulty sentence without recasting it into a different essay.
4. Explain the repair in one rule-phrase.
5. Start a personal “top 20 faults” list from the error log.

Teacher plan (90 minutes)

Time	Move
0–8	Recap comma splice vs <i>however</i> .
8–20	Teach the method (below). Put the five families on the wall.
20–55	15 timed items. 90 seconds each. Students write <i>Family</i> + <i>corrected sentence</i> . Then pair-check against the teacher’s key.
55–80	Transfer: a 120-word dirty paragraph containing planted errors from the five families. Students correct in situ (do not rewrite from scratch).
80–90	Homework, exit. Build top-20 list.

Traps: students “improve” style and lose the exam mark; two corrections when one was asked; changing meaning.

Stretch: items with two legal repairs — discuss which is *smallest*.

Student notes

1. The official skill

FPSC’s sentence-correction instruction (Precis & Composition) is the law of this room:

Rewrite with really needed correction only, without making unnecessary alterations.

That is also how you should proofread a CSS essay in the last ten minutes: **hunt the fault, change the smallest piece, leave the rest.**

2. The method (90 seconds an item)

1. Read once for meaning.
2. Test the **five families** in order (they cover most papers):
 - **A** agreement (subject–verb, one of, many a, neither/nor)
 - **Art** articles and countability
 - **P** preposition / pair (*prefer to, despite, discuss*)
 - **T** tense and time markers
 - **C** condition (*if will, unless not, until not*)
3. Make the smallest change.
4. Re-read. If a new fault appeared, you recast too much.
5. Write the **family name** in the margin. If you cannot name it, you guessed.

Later (Session 15) we add parallelism, modifiers, diction, Urduisms.

3. Family A — agreement (reminders)

- *The quality of X is***
- *One of the reasons is***
- *Many a student fails***
- *Each of the files has***
- *Neither the notes nor the outline is / **Neither the outline nor the **notes are***
- *He is one of the officers who have***
- *The poor are***

4. Family Art — articles and count

- *an honest, a university, an FPSC paper*
- *information, advice, evidence — uncountable*
- *the Constitution, Pakistan (no the), the poor*
- *one of the most serious problems***

5. Family P — small words

- *discuss Ø, comprise Ø, consist of, despite Ø, in spite of*
- *prefer to, senior to, different from, interested in, accused of, charged with*
- *since + point; for + period*
- *between two; among a group*

6. Family T — tense and time

- *no present perfect + yesterday / last year / in 2010*
- *did not + base*
- *has written, not has wrote*
- *thesis in present; dated fact in past*
- *since 2018 + present perfect*

7. Family C — condition

- *If + present, will in the other clause*

- *unless* without extra *not*
- *until* + the event you wait for (positive)
- *If I were / If she had known* (not *would have* in the if-clause)

8. What “smallest change” looks like

Faulty: *One of the main reason are unemployment.*

Over-rewrite: *Unemployment is a major driver of unrest among urban youth.* (new sentence — **zero marks** if this were a correction item)

Smallest: *One of the main reasons is unemployment.*

Urdu-interference box (preview; full hunt in Session 15)

Even in these five families, Urdu leaves fingerprints: *one of the reason, discuss about, since five years, if I will, unless you don't*. Diagnose in English rule-names, not “it sounds wrong.”

Class drill (timed)

For each: **Family** + **corrected sentence**. Do not recast.

1. The quality of these reforms are poor.
2. She discussed about the NFC award.
3. He has submitted the form yesterday.
4. One of the most serious problem are extremism.
5. If the monsoon will fail, wheat will be imported.
6. Despite of the stay, demolition began.
7. Many a candidates have failed the essay.
8. Pakistan is facing this crisis since 2018.
9. The cabinet comprises of thirty ministers.
10. Wait until the House does not rise.
11. Neither the minister nor the aides was briefed. (aides = nearer)
12. She did not wrote the précis.
13. An university degree is not an employment.
14. Unless you don't meter the wells, the city will go dry.
15. He is one of those officers who signs every file.

Essay-transfer task

Dirty paragraph (correct **in situ**; do not rewrite from a blank page):

Poverty is one of the main threat to the national security, government is not serious about it since many years. If the state will not tax the elite the poor will keep paying a sales tax. Despite of the speeches, informations on the true budget is weak. Many a programmes has been launched, however they collapses after the first year. The quality of these programmes are not audited. Unless the cabinet does not publish the figures, the debate will remain childish.

Count your corrections. Aim for **every** planted fault, nothing else.

Homework

1. Repeat the 15 class items from memory the next morning.
 2. From your error log, pick 10 personal faults and write a “smallest change” repair plus family name.
 3. Write 5 new faulty sentences (deliberately) for a partner to diagnose — then key them.
 4. Read Session 15’s family list once.
-

Exit ticket

1. What does FPSC forbid besides leaving the error?
 2. Name the five families of this session.
 3. Smallest repair: *She has met him last Monday.*
 4. Why is *Unemployment is rising among the youth* a bad “correction” of item 4?
-

Teacher mark pointers

- 11: nearer subject *aides* → *were*.
- 13: *A university degree is not employment.* (or *not a guarantee of employment* — slightly bigger; accept *not employment* / *not a job*).
- 14: drop *don’t*: *Unless you meter the wells...*
- 15: *who sign*** (officers).
- Dirty paragraph key is in the answer-key file. If a student also “improves” *childish* to *uninformed*, do not punish, but remind them that the exam item would not require it.

Session 15 — Removing Errors II (Parallelism, Modifiers, Diction, Urduisms)

Module C · Accuracy and transfer

Duration: 90 minutes

Exam link: remaining correction types; the language that makes a CSS essay look “Pakistani-translated”

Outcomes

The student can:

1. Repair **parallelism** after *and, or, not only...but also, both...and*.
2. Place **modifiers** next to the word they describe; fix dangling *-ing*.
3. Replace **wrong words** (*affect/effect, principal/principle, lose/loose*) in a CSS sentence.
4. Translate-back the **Urduism list** into examiner-safe English.
5. Clean a full student-style paragraph of mixed faults, still using smallest change where possible, then a second pass for diction.

Teacher plan (90 minutes)

Time	Move
0–8	Recap five families: one item each, oral.
8–28	Parallelism. Dangling modifiers. Confused pairs. Urduism wall (the 25).
28–50	Mixed drill (12 items).
50–78	Transfer: two-pass edit of a 150-word dirty essay body on <i>youth unemployment</i> — Pass 1 grammar families 14+15; Pass 2 kill cliché (<i>need of the hour, concrete steps, last but not the least</i>).
78–86	Read two cleaned versions aloud. Vote which still sounds like a human.
86–90	Homework, exit.

Traps: over-Latinising (*henceforth, wherein, aforementioned*); replacing Urduisms with equally empty “academy English”.

Stretch: misplaced only: *The committee only published the summary in June vs only the summary vs only in June.*

Student notes

1. Parallelism

Equal ideas take equal form.

Stem	Parallel
and / or	<i>to tax, to spend and to explain</i>
not only ... but also	<i>not only corrupt but also incompetent** (adj + adj)</i>
both ... and	<i>both in law and in practice**</i>
either ... or	<i>either publish or resign**</i>
comparisons	<i>better to audit than to guess**</i>

Faulty: *The job is to examine files, interviewing witnesses and a report.*

Repaired: *The job is to examine files, interview witnesses and write a report.*

2. Modifiers must sit next to the thing they describe

Dangling: the opening phrase has no doer in the subject that follows.

- Faulty: *Walking into the secretariat, the files were on the floor.* (the files were not walking)
- Right: *Walking into the secretariat, I found the files on the floor.*
- Right: *When I walked into the secretariat, the files were on the floor.*

Misplaced:

- Faulty: *The minister said in June the bill would die in the House.* (did he say it in June, or would it die in June?)
- Right: *In June the minister said that the bill would die in the House.*
or *The minister said that the bill would die in the House in June.*

only, almost, even go next to the word they limit.

3. Diction: words CSS students confuse

Use the meaning, then a CSS sentence.

Pair	Meaning	CSS line
affect / effect	v. influence / n. result (also v. to bring about)	<i>Inflation affects the poor. The effect is hunger.</i>
principal / principle	chief / moral rule	<i>the principal officer; a principle of justice</i>
advice / advise	noun / verb	<i>advice is cheap; I advise silence</i>
practice / practise	n. / v. (BrE)	<i>in practice; to practise law</i>
licence / license	n. / v. (BrE)	<i>a driving licence; to license a channel</i>
lose / loose	fail to keep / not tight	<i>lose an election; a loose coalition</i>
compliment / complement	praise / complete	<i>the two policies complement each other</i>
council / counsel	body / advice	<i>the cabinet is not a council of war; counsel of caution</i>
stationary / stationery	unmoving / paper	<i>prices were not stationary; buy stationery**</i>
economic / economical	of the economy / thrifty	<i>economic policy; an economical stove</i>
historic / historical	important in history / about history	<i>a historic vote; historical evidence</i>

Pair	Meaning	CSS line
political / politic	of politics / prudent	<i>a politic silence</i>
imply / infer	speaker suggests / listener concludes	<i>The report implies fraud. We infer that the audit failed.</i>
fewer / less	count / uncount	<i>fewer jobs, less inflation</i>
between / among	two / group	

Ten pairs is enough for this session. A full pair-of-words bank belongs to the Precis course.

4. The Urduism / academy-cliché list (memorise)

Don't	Do
I am agree	I agree
according to me	in my view / drop it
discuss about	discuss
comprise of	comprise / consist of
despite of	despite
although ... but	pick one
return back / repeat again	return / repeat
one of the reason	one of the reasons
informations / furnitures / advices	information / furniture / advice
peoples (citizens)	people
since five years	for five years
if I will	if I
unless you don't	unless you
did not went	did not go
more better	better
very unique	unique
last but not the least	finally
the need of the hour	Pakistan must / the priority is
take concrete steps	name the act
in this contemporary era	now / today / this decade
it is crystal clear	the figures show / it is clear
the masses	people / citizens / voters
do the needful	do the job named
I belong to a middle class family (as an essay open)	do not open an essay with your biography

Don't	Do
government should think over it	the cabinet should decide / fund / publish

5. Two-pass proofreading in the exam hall

Pass 1 (grammar): families from Sessions 14–15. Circle verbs, articles, prepositions.

Pass 2 (diction): kill clichés and wrong pairs.

Pass 3 (only if time): sentence length. Split anything you cannot read in one breath.

Never start Pass 2 before Pass 1. A pretty cliché that disagrees with its subject still fails.

Urdu-interference box (word order)

Urdu SOV (*wo file complete kar chuka hai*) can produce:

- *He the file has completed yesterday.* → *He completed the file yesterday.*
- *Is policy of the government as a stacked of: The government's policy is tighter.*

Class drill

A. Parallelism and modifiers

1. The act requires the board to audit accounts, publishing names and a fine.
2. Not only the FBR but also wasting time is the problem. (make a legal not only...but also)
3. Rushing to the House, the bill was tabled.
4. The committee only met the unions in March. (three different meanings — write all three)

B. Diction

5. The new tax will effect retailers.
6. She lost a lose coalition.
7. We infer in the first paragraph that the writer hates the poor; the writer actually implies a subsidy. (repair the pair)
8. There are less jobs than applicants.

C. Urduisms / clichés

9. According to me, government should take concrete steps.
10. Last but not the least, we must discuss about education.
11. Although the policy is sound but implementation is weak.
12. I am agree that informations are missing.

Essay-transfer task

Dirty body paragraph:

In this contemporary era the youth of Pakistan is facing a lot of problems, unemployment is one of the main reason. Walking into the cities, jobs are not there. Government should take concrete steps, provide skill and that the industry is growing. According to me if the state will not listen the youth will go towards frustration. Last but not the least, more better education is the need of the hour and it will effect the future of the masses.

Pass 1: grammar (agreement, tense, articles, prepositions, conditionals, voice, modifiers, parallelism, punctuation).

Pass 2: diction and clichés.

Write the cleaned paragraph in **110–140 words**. Keep the meaning. Do not add a fake quotation.

Homework

1. Learn the Urduism table. Cover the right column.
2. 10 pair-of-words sentences (the table in this session).
3. Take an old paragraph of yours and run two-pass edit. Staple old and new into the error log.
4. Prepare Session 16: bring the formula sheet's mini-paragraph formula.

Exit ticket

1. Repair the dangling: *Reading the report, the errors were obvious.*
2. *affect* or *effect*: Inflation will ____ the poor. The ____ will be hunger.
3. Two replacements for *take concrete steps*.
4. Why is *not only corrupt but also a failure* ugly?

Teacher mark pointers

- 2 possible: *Not only the FBR but also the courts wasted time.* / *The problem is not only delay at the FBR but also wasted hearings.*
- 3: *Rushing to the House, the minister tabled the bill.*
- 4: *met the unions only in March* / *met only the unions in March* / *only the committee met the unions in March.*
- 7: *The first paragraph implies...; we infer...*
- Cleaned transfer should not still contain *need of the hour* or *masses* if Pass 2 was done. A student who keeps one cliché but has perfect grammar: mark diction, not grammar.

Session 16 — From Grammar to Paragraph

Module C • Accuracy and transfer

Duration: 90 minutes

Exam link: essay body paragraphs — cohesion, topic sentence, examiner demand for logical organisation

Outcomes

The student can:

1. Write a **topic sentence** that is a claim, not a heading.
2. Build a **PEEL-style** paragraph (Point, Evidence, Explanation, Link) with legal tense movement.
3. Use **old-to-new** cohesion (repeat a key noun or a precise *this* + *noun*).
4. Stay in academic register without cliché or autobiography.
5. Produce one 140–160 word CSS paragraph with fewer than three grammar faults.

Teacher plan (90 minutes)

Time	Move
0–8	Recap two-pass edit. One Urduism on the board.
8–25	What a CSS paragraph is. Topic sentence clinic (rewrite 6 headings into claims). PEEL + tense beats from Session 8. Cohesion without <i>moreover</i> addiction.
25–45	Guided: class writes one paragraph together on the board (<i>A census is a political act</i>). Students call the next sentence; teacher refuses fragments, splices, empty passives.
45–78	Independent: 150 words on <i>The rule of law is a daily habit of institutions, not a slogan</i> . Silent. Then swap: partner uses codes T/A/P/S only.
78–88	Two anonymous paragraphs on the projector/board. Live repair.
88–90	Homework: outline for Session 17 mini-essay.

Traps: paragraph that is a list of slogans; *this* with no noun; five connectors; no evidence beat.

Stretch: a counter-sentence (*however*) in the middle without killing the topic sentence.

Student notes

1. The paragraph is the essay in miniature

FPSC subject experts asked for:

- a compact topic sentence that shows you understood the topic
- logical organisation

- coherence between paragraphs
- cohesion inside the argument
- clarity
- a finish

Session 16 trains **one paragraph**. Session 17 stacks four of them under a clock.

2. A topic sentence is a claim

Heading (fail)	Claim (pass)
<i>Rule of law</i>	<i>The rule of law is the habit of applying the same rule to friends and opponents.</i>
<i>Problems of education</i>	<i>Public education fails first as a teacher problem, not as a building problem.</i>
<i>Climate change in Pakistan</i>	<i>Pakistan's climate risk is a water-management failure before it is a carbon story.</i>

A topic sentence is usually **present simple**, 12–22 words, no quotation, no *in this paragraph I will discuss*.

3. PEEL (adapted for CSS)

Beat	Job	Typical tense
P Point	topic sentence = claim	present simple
E Evidence	fact, example, named institution, short dated event	past simple or present perfect
E Explanation	why the evidence supports the claim	present; <i>this + noun</i>
L Link	back to the essay thesis or onward to the next idea	present; <i>therefore / yet / if</i>

You may insert **However + limit** between Evidence and Explanation. One concession makes you look adult. Three concessions make you look lost.

4. Cohesion: glue, not decoration

Glue is usually **grammar**, not a connector word.

1. Repeat a key noun: *census ... the census ... that count*
2. Use *this / that / these / such* + **noun**: *this delay, such guesswork*
3. Use a pronoun only when the antecedent is obvious
4. Use a subordinator: *because, although, if, which*
5. Then, if still needed, one sentence adverb: *however, therefore*

Old-to-new: end sentence 1 with an idea; start sentence 2 with that idea.

- *The census is late. This delay poisons the NFC.*
Not: *The census is late. Moreover, inflation is also a problem.* (new rabbit)

5. Register

Write as a future officer, not as a TV tickers, not as a Victorian.

- Prefer short verbs: *cut, fund, publish, meter, audit, tax, enforce.*
- Prefer concrete nouns: *rolls, drains, canal, courtroom, classroom.*

- Do not address the examiner.
- Do not open with *I*. A later *this essay argues* once is enough; even that can go.

6. Model paragraph (study the verbs)

Topic: *A census is a political act.*

A census is a political act because it decides who is counted as a claimant on the federal purse. Pakistan has postponed that count more than once, and each postponement has been explained as a technical hitch. In 2017 the exercise still left provinces arguing about the method as much as the number. This quarrel was not a statistician's hobby: NFC shares, seats and development funds move with the table. If the next census is again treated as a tactic rather than as a public good, the federation will keep bargaining in the dark. A state that fears its own headcount cannot claim adult budgeting.

Check:

- Topic claim in present.
- Present perfect for the repeating postponement.
- One dated past.
- *This quarrel* = cohesion.
- Type-1 *if* for the future.
- No *need of the hour*.
- Length: about 130 words.

7. Failure modes

- **Slogan stack:** five present-simple moral sentences, no evidence.
- **Tense soup:** past and present in the same beat without a reason.
- **Connector addiction:** *moreover* four times.
- **Ghost paragraph:** all passives, no institution named.
- **Fragment:** *Which is a serious problem.*
- **Splice:** *The census is late, the NFC is toxic.*

Urdu-interference box

Urdu *mazmoon* paragraphs sometimes restart the topic every sentence (*Taleem bohat zaroori hai. Taleem ke baghair qaum nahi chal sakti. Taleem par budget kam hai.*). In English that reads like a hammer. Use cohesion: *Public education is the cheapest state-building tool. That cheapness is lost when teachers are absent from the payroll's useful end: the classroom.*

Class drill

A. Rewrite as topic sentences (one sentence each).

1. Water crisis
2. Social media

3. Gender and the labour force
4. Civil service reform
5. Extremism
6. Inflation

B. Repair cohesion

7. *The rolls are dirty. Moreover, climate change is real.* (make a real link or split into two paragraphs' worth of honesty — here, rewrite so sentence 2 belongs to sentence 1)

C. Diagnose the model

8. List every finite verb in the model paragraph and name its tense. Confirm the four PEEL beats.
-

Essay-transfer task

Write **150 words** (± 10) on:

The rule of law is a daily habit of institutions, not a slogan.

Constraints:

- PEEL beats (you may label them lightly in the margin).
- One dated or institutional piece of evidence (court, parliament, police, FBR, ECP — keep it modest).
- One *this* + *noun*.
- One *although* or *if*.
- Zero items from the Session 15 cliché list.
- Circle every finite verb.

Partner marks with T/A/P/S only. Writer repairs in a different colour.

Homework

1. Rewrite today's paragraph once, shortening any sentence over 28 words.
 2. Outline for Session 17 (on paper, 12 minutes): topic **"A state that cannot tax fairly cannot spend honestly."**
 - thesis (1 sentence)
 - three paragraph topic sentences
 - one line of evidence under each
 - concluding sentence
 3. Formula sheet: revise sections 4, 6, 13, 14.
 4. Sleep. Tomorrow is timed.
-

Exit ticket

1. What makes a topic sentence different from a heading?
2. Write a legal *this* + *noun* follow-on after *The drains were not de-silted*.
3. Which tense usually carries the topic sentence?

4. Name one cohesion tool that is not a connector word.

| Teacher mark pointers

- Award the transfer on **language first** (the 3-faults-per-100-words standard from the syllabus). Then a 5-mark structure tick: claim / evidence / link.
- Do not require original research. Punish fake precision (*exactly 43.2%*) unless the student truly knows a figure. Modest evidence beats invented decimals.
- If the partner used codes lazily (*S* on every line), make them re-mark one sentence with a named family.

Session 17 — Capstone: Timed Mini-Essay and Remediation

Module C • Accuracy and transfer

Duration: 90 minutes

Exam link: full essay paper conditions in miniature; language standard for the rest of CSS prep

Outcomes

The student can:

1. Plan a four-part mini-essay in 8 minutes.
2. Write **250–300 words** in 40 minutes on a known CSS-style claim.
3. Apply two-pass proofreading in 7 minutes.
4. Read a marked script against the **language rubric** and fill a remediation map.
5. Leave the course with a personal “next 30 days” grammar plan.

Teacher plan (90 minutes)

Time	Move
0–5	Rules of the room. Paper, pen, formula sheet face down until planning ends. No phones.
5–13	Silent outline. Teacher walks, checks that outlines are claims not headings.
13–53	Write 250–300 words. Teacher on the clock, no coaching.
53–60	Proofread (two passes). Formula sheet allowed now.
60–70	Scripts swapped or teacher samples 4 scripts on the board if the batch is small. Partners mark with the rubric (language 25, structure 15).
70–85	Remediation map. Students copy teacher’s common-fault tally.
85–90	What this course was; what the next course is. Collect scripts.

If the batch cannot mark fairly, collect scripts, mark overnight, and use a 20-minute extra sitting for feedback. Do not skip the write.

Traps: students trying to produce a full 2500-word CSS essay in 40 minutes — stop them. This is a **language capstone**, not the full essay course.

Stretch: a fifth paragraph (counter + rebuttal) if they finish before 35 minutes with clean language.

Student notes

1. What you are writing today

Title: A state that cannot tax fairly cannot spend honestly.

This is a **mini-essay**, not the FPSC 2500–3000 word product. It has the **shape** of a CSS essay and the **language standard** of one.

2. Shape (four blocks)

Block	Words	Job
Opening	50–70	unpack the title; one thesis sentence that takes a position
Body 1	70–90	tax fairness (who is outside the net; institutions: FBR / provincial boards)
Body 2	70–90	dishonest or wasteful spending as a result (subsidies, development funds, unbudgeted energy)
Close	40–60	therefore: publish, broaden, audit — named actors, <i>must/should</i> , no slogan

Optional if fast: a short counter (*A state may tax harshly and still waste*) + rebuttal (*fairness is about who pays, not only how much*).

3. Opening — do not do these

- dictionary definition of *state*, *tax*, or *honest*
- *In this contemporary era...*
- a quotation from a poet
- *According to me*
- restating the title with *indeed, it is true that*

Do this:

- Explain the **logic** of the title in your own grammar.
- End the opening with a **thesis**: *Fair taxation is the first audit of a government; without it, public spending becomes patronage.*

4. Language non-negotiables (today's rubric)

You lose language marks for:

- fragments and comma splices
- tense drift inside a beat
- SVA faults
- article/preposition/Urduism clusters
- empty passives
- *unless...not / if...will*
- cliché list from Session 15

You do **not** lose language marks today for missing a rare current-affairs figure. Inventing a fake precise statistic **does** lose honesty marks — skip the decimal if you do not know it.

5. Proofreading order (7 minutes)

1. Circle every finite verb. Check tense and agreement.
2. Scan *a/an/the* and *of/in/on/to/for/since*.
3. Scan *although/but, unless, however* punctuation.
4. Split any sentence you cannot read in one breath.
5. Title-check: did you answer **tax** and **spend**, not only one?

6. After you get the script back — remediation map

Copy this table into the error log:

Family	Ticks in my script	30-day drill
Sentence integrity (frag/splice)		5 repairs daily, Session 1 drill style
Articles / count		uncountable list + 10 cloze
Prepositions		collocation table, cover-and-say
Tense		four-box grids, mixed paragraph
Agreement		head-noun hunt, 10 items
Voice / empty passive		name the actor
Narration / quoting		3 conversions
Conditionals		0–3 ladder
Punctuation		splice → three repairs
Diction / Urduism		cliché list, reverse test
Cohesion / topic sentence		PEEL twice a week

Any family with **2+ ticks** is a daily 15-minute drill for two weeks. Do not “revise everything”. Revise the wound.

7. What “language-ready” means (from the syllabus)

You are ready to start full-length CSS essay practice when:

- fewer than 3 grammar faults per 100 words in this timed script
- no tense drift inside a paragraph
- articles and prepositions mostly right
- you can report a finding in indirect speech
- you can use active and passive on purpose
- you can name a fault before you fix it

If you are not there, do **not** jump to 2500-word daily essays. You will only fossilise the error. Repeat Sessions 14–16 on new topics for two weeks, then write another mini-essay.

8. The next course (not today)

- full outline of a 2500–3000 word CSS essay
- introductions that are not templates
- 8–10 paragraph architecture

- content banks (governance, climate, economy, foreign policy, gender, technology)
- precis, pairs of words, translation

This 17-session pack was the **engine**. Keep the formula sheet. Keep the error log. The log is more valuable than a quotation booklet.

Classroom materials

- Lined paper, margin for codes
 - Printed rubric (`assessments/03-final-mini-essay.md`)
 - Formula sheet for the proofreading window only
-

Timed prompt (write on the board)

Mini-essay (250–300 words, 40 minutes + 8 minutes plan + 7 minutes proofread)

A state that cannot tax fairly cannot spend honestly.

Take a clear position. Use PEEL in each body paragraph. British spelling. No contractions. No cliché list. Name at least two institutions.

Partner marking (10 minutes)

Use the rubric. Do not rewrite the essay. Codes in the margin. A score out of 40. One gold sentence starred. One wreck bracketed.

Then return the script. The writer copies faults into the remediation map **in their own hand**. That copying is the learning.

Homework (post-course)

1. Finish the remediation map with honest ticks.
 2. 30-day calendar: 15 minutes grammar drill + one 120-word PEEL paragraph, four days a week.
 3. One extra mini-essay next week on *Public education is cheaper than policing a frustrated generation*. Same timing.
 4. Keep the error log until the written exam.
-

Exit ticket (if time; else oral)

1. What will you drill in the next 48 hours? (one family)
 2. Quote your own thesis from today's script.
 3. Name one empty sentence you deleted in proofreading.
 4. Are you language-ready for full essays? Yes / not yet — say why in one line.
-

| Teacher mark pointers

- Mark language harder than content. A wise, broken sentence still fails CSS.
- If 70% of the batch is “not yet”, do not start the full essay course. Repeat error sessions.
- Return scripts with **codes**, not essays rewritten in the teacher’s English. The student must do the repair.
- Celebrate one gold sentence publicly. The room should hear what “clean” sounds like.

Part C — Tests and keys

Diagnostic, mid-course test, final rubric, error log, then teacher answer keys.

Diagnostic Test — Session 1

Time: 25 minutes

Use: unmarked or /50 — teacher sees the wound; student starts the error log

Do not teach the paper first. Sit it cold.

Write on the script. British spelling.

A. Sentence integrity (6 × 1)

Label **S** (sentence), **F** (fragment), **R** (run-on). Do not rewrite yet.

1. Although the census was delayed.
2. Inflation is high, the poor suffer.
3. The civil service still attracts talent.
4. Because the rolls are dirty the petition failed.
5. To reform the police overnight.
6. Social media spreads rumour it also spreads evidence.

B. Articles and nouns (6 × 1)

Fill *a / an / the / Ø*.

7. ___ Pakistan is ___ federation under ___ Constitution of 1973.
8. ___ information in the report was thin.
9. She is ___ honest officer with ___ university degree.
10. One of ___ reason is elite capture. (This item is already faulty; rewrite the whole sentence.)

C. Prepositions and small words (6 × 1)

Correct the sentence. Smallest change.

11. They discussed about the NFC award.
12. The cabinet comprises of twenty ministers.
13. Despite of the rain, polling continued.
14. I prefer governance than slogans.
15. He has lived here since five years.

16. She is senior than the secretary.

| D. Tense and verbs (6 × 1)

17. She did not went to the centre.

18. I am agree with the thesis.

19. The government has announced the package last Monday.

20. If the monsoon will fail, wheat will be imported.

21. He is knowing the file.

22. In 1947 Pakistan has become independent.

| E. Agreement (5 × 1)

Choose or repair.

23. The quality of the reforms (is / are) poor.

24. Each of the provinces (has / have) a grievance.

25. Many a candidate (fail / fails).

26. Neither the notes nor the outline (was / were) ready.

27. The poor (is / are) paying the sales tax.

| F. Voice, narration, punctuation (5 × 1)

28. The accident was happened at dawn. (repair)

29. He said me that he was ready. (repair)

30. He asked that where did I live. (repair)

31. The law exists, however it is dead. (punctuate / repair)

32. Its a long delay. (repair)

| G. Mini-writing (10 marks)

80–100 words. Topic: *Why do CSS essays fail?*

Do not use a dictionary definition. Write in paragraphs. The teacher will code T / A / P / S, not line-edit.

| Teacher scoring (optional /50)

A–F items 1–9, 11–32 = 31 points (item 10 = 2 points for a full correct rewrite: *One of the reasons is elite capture.*).

If you want a clean /40 objective + /10 writing, score A–F as 40 by treating 10 as two marks and dropping nothing;

recommended: /40 objective + /10 writing = /50.

Writing /10:

- 4 language (verbs, articles, splices)
- 3 sentence control
- 3 relevance and sense

After marking, return **codes**, not a rewritten essay. Students copy every coded fault into the error log before Session 2.

Mid-Course Test — After Session 9

Time: 40 minutes

Marks: 50

Coverage: Sessions 1–9 (sentence, parts of speech, tenses, agreement)

Rule: smallest needed correction; name the family where asked.

1. Diagnosis (10 × 1)

For each, write **S / F / R** or the **part of speech** of the underlined word, as instructed.

1. (S/F/R) While the state borrowed heavily.
2. (S/F/R) The policy is sound it is unfunded.
3. POS: The **however** in *The law exists. However, it is dead.* — (conjunction / sentence adverb / preposition)
4. POS: **must** in *Pakistan must meter water.*
5. POS: **information** (countable / uncountable)
6. POS: **poor** in *The poor pay more.* (adjective as class noun / adverb)
7. POS: **since** in *since 2018* (preposition / conjunction / adverb) — here it is a preposition of time.
8. (S/F/R) Although the law exists, it is dead.
9. POS: **to** in *prefer tea to coffee*
10. POS: **taking** in *Taking the census is a political act.* (gerund / finite verb)

2. Articles, prepositions, collocations (10 × 1)

Rewrite. Smallest change.

11. The Pakistan faces a water shock.
12. She gave me an advice.
13. They discussed about climate.
14. The panel consists 12 members.
15. Despite of the stay, work continued.
16. He is interested on water law.
17. She is junior than the secretary.
18. We have lived here for 2019.
19. Between the four provinces the quarrel continues.
20. Although the bill passed but the rules never came.

3. Tenses (10 × 1)

21. Pakistan (is / has been) a federation since 1973.
22. The court (has delivered / delivered) the verdict an hour ago.
23. She (knows / is knowing) the file.
24. If the census (will slip / slips) again, the NFC will be blind.

25. By 2030 several cities (will run / will have run) out of cheap groundwater if nothing changes. (choose the “completed by a deadline” form)
26. Repair: He did not wrote the outline.
27. Repair: Yesterday I have met the officer.
28. Repair: She is working here since 2020.
29. He said that he (will / would) publish the figures. (past reporting)
30. In 1973 Pakistan (adopts / adopted / has adopted) the Constitution.

4. Agreement and architecture (10 × 1)

31. The quality of these reports (is / are) uneven.
32. Each of the secretaries (has / have) a veto.
33. Many a candidate (fail / fails).
34. The secretary as well as the aides (was / were) late.
35. Neither the outline nor the notes (was / were) ready.
36. He is one of those writers who (revises / revise) daily.
37. He is the only one of those writers who (revises / revise) daily.
38. A number of files (is / are) missing.
39. The number of files (is / are) missing.
40. Repair parallelism: The commission was asked to examine the files, interviewing witnesses and a report.

5. Paragraph (10 marks)

120 words. Topic: *Independent data is a condition of adult government.*

Must include:

- a present-simple thesis
- one present perfect with *since* or *for*
- one past illustration (a year or an institution)
- no comma splice
- circle every finite verb

Mark: 6 language, 4 control of tense/structure.

Final Mini-Essay — Session 17

Time: 8 minutes plan + 40 minutes write + 7 minutes proofread

Length: 250–300 words

Marks: 40 (language 25 + structure 15)

Prompt

A state that cannot tax fairly cannot spend honestly.

Take a position. British spelling. No contractions. Name at least two institutions.

Language rubric /25

Band	Marks	What the script looks like
Clean	21–25	Fewer than 3 grammar faults per 100 words. Tense controlled. Articles and prepositions mostly right. No cliché stock. Voice on purpose.
Work-able	16–20	Meaning always clear. Recurring but limited faults (e.g. articles). No collapse of sentence integrity.
Fragile	10–15	Frequent SVA/tense/Urduism. Some splices or fragments. Examiner would get tired.
Not ready	0–9	Language hides the argument. Run-ons, tense soup, empty passives, cliché open.

Deduct inside the band for: comma splices, *if...will*, *unless...not*, *I am agree*, empty *steps should be taken*, *the need of the hour*, dictionary opening.

Structure rubric /15

Beat	Marks	Evidence
Thesis that unpacks both tax and spend	4	Last sentence of opening is a claim, not a heading
Body 1 — fairness of tax	3	Institution named; PEEL-ish
Body 2 — honesty of spend	3	Linked to body 1, not a new essay
Close — named actors + modal	3	<i>must/should</i> , no slogan
Cohesion	2	<i>this</i> + <i>noun</i> or old-to-new; not <i>moreover</i> four times

Partner codes (margin)

T tense · **A** article/agreement · **P** preposition/punctuation/pair · **S** structure (fragment, splice, voice, modifier, parallelism)

Star **one gold sentence**. Bracket **one wreck**.

| Language-ready decision (teacher)

Tick one:

- ☐ **Ready** for full CSS essay practice (clean or high workable, structure ≥ 10)
- ☐ **Not yet** — 15 minutes daily on the families ticked in the remediation map; repeat a mini-essay in 7 days

Do not inflate. A kind lie here produces a failed Essay paper later.

Error Log Template

Print several copies. One line per fault. If the same fault appears three times, highlight it. That is your drill.

Date	Ses- sion	My sentence (copy ex- actly)	Code T/A/P/S or family name	Smallest re- pair	Rule in 5 words

Top 20 personal faults (fill after Session 14)

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.
- 4.
- 5.
- 6.
- 7.
- 8.
- 9.
- 10.
- 11.
- 12.
- 13.
- 14.
- 15.
- 16.
- 17.
- 18.
- 19.
- 20.

30-day tally (after Session 17)

Family	Ticks in capstone	Daily drill (15 min)	Days 1–14 done?
Sentence integrity			
Articles / count			
Prepositions			

Family	Ticks in capstone	Daily drill (15 min)	Days 1–14 done?
Tense			
Agreement			
Voice			
Narration			
Conditionals			
Punctuation			
Diction / Urduism			
Cohesion			

Answer Keys — Sessions 1–17 and Tests

Teacher copy. Do not print the whole file for students. Release after each attempt.

Where two answers are legal, both are listed. Prefer the **smallest change**.

Session 1 — Class drill

1. F — *Governance without accountability fails.* / *Governance without accountability is theatre.*
2. R — *The civil service recruits talent. It does not always retain it.* / *...talent, but it does not...*
3. F — *When a state cannot tax fairly, it loses legitimacy.*
4. S
5. S (complex). Prefer a comma: *Because the census was delayed, the planning stayed blind.*
6. R — *Social media spreads rumour. It also spreads evidence.* / *...rumour; it also...* / *...rumour, but it also...*
7. F — *To reform the police overnight is impossible.* / *Nobody can reform the police overnight.*
8. S

Homework 3

- a. *Poverty is increasing. The government is not serious.* / *...increasing, and the government...*
- b. *Although the policy is good, implementation is weak.* OR *The policy is good, but implementation is weak.*
- c. *Pakistan is facing many challenges in the education sector.*
- d. Add a main clause: *Because the youth is frustrated, the street fills easily.* (Also acceptable: *The youth are frustrated if youth is treated as plural.*)
- e. *Climate change is real. It is already here.* / semicolon / *because*

Exit ticket

1. Subject + finite verb + complete thought.
 2. Stop / semicolon / *and*.
 3. No — dependent clause, no independent clause.
 4. Simple, compound, complex, compound-complex.
-

Session 2

A

1. **The** rule of law; **a** slogan; **a** daily habit
2. **The** information; **the** bureau
3. **An** honest broker; Ø regional politics (or *in regional politics* already has *in*; zero before *regional politics*)
4. Ø poverty; Ø Thar / **the** Thar (accept *the Thar*); **the** same; Ø poverty (second general) / *poverty in a city slum*
5. **The** United Nations; Ø water stress; **the** Indus basin

B

6. *One of the main causes of unrest is unemployment.*

7. *Pakistan must protect its farmers.*
8. *This census delay is alarming.*
9. *She is an honest civil servant.*
10. *Much advice was ignored. / Many pieces of advice were ignored.*

Homework 2

- a. *A university degree does not guarantee Ø employment.*
- b. *Parliament passed a bill on climate / on the climate emergency.* (drop unnecessary *the* before *climate* if general)
- c. *Each of the provinces has a grievance.*
- d. *The poor need the state.*
- e. *One of the most serious problems is extremism.*

Exit

1. *Information* is uncountable.
 2. *reforms* / *is*
 3. *an* FPSC; *a* unique; *an* hour
 4. *its* civil service
-

Session 3

A (finite verbs)

1. *has struck* — aux *has* + lexical *struck*
2. *should not legislate* — modal + lexical
3. *is* — lexical/linking (the infinitive phrase is the subject)
4. *is arriving* (aux *is* + lexical); *predicted* (lexical, past)

B

5. *did not know***
6. *I agree***
7. *must Ø reform*
8. *The state can raise / is able to raise* (not both)
9. *Inflation must be controlled. / It is necessary that inflation be controlled.*
10. Past habit: *They used to live without gas in winter.* Accustomed: *They are used to living without gas in winter.*

C

11. *must*
12. *should* (must also acceptable if framed as duty)
13. *would*
14. *must not*
15. *may / might*

Homework 2

- a. *He failed the paper.*
 - b. *She suggested that I write daily. / She advised me to write daily.*
 - c. *The committee has agreed.*
 - d. *We should consider the poor.*
 - e. *Did the policy succeed?*
-

Session 4

1. clear; clearly
2. hard; hardly
3. a few
4. little
5. colder
6. *prefer governance to slogans*
7. *This solution is better.*
8. *He ran fast towards the court.*
9. *Every province has a complaint.*
10. *The poor are ignored...*
11. *junior to the secretary*
12. *too many files and too much work*

Transfer: accept any rewrite that deletes the intensifier and adds a concrete noun/actor. Reject a longer empty sentence.

Session 5

1. Ø
2. of
3. Ø
4. In
5. since
6. in
7. of
8. with
9. Ø (*Despite the stay order*)
10. to
11. drop *but* OR drop *Although*
12. drop *so* OR drop *Because*
13. stop or semicolon before *however*; comma after *however*
14. *Wait until the House rises.*
15. *Among the four provinces... / Between the federation and the provinces...*

Exit: *consist* takes *of*; *discuss climate*; *however* is not a coordinator; *for six years, since 2018*.

Session 6

1. present simple — general law
2. present continuous — this quarter
3. present perfect — result now
4. present perfect continuous — duration since a point
5. has been
6. delivered (ago → past simple)
7. knows
8. Since; has become
9. has not yet published
10. Law: *Water tables fall every year*. Trend: *Water tables have been falling / have fallen this decade*.
11. *announced ... last Monday* (past simple)
12. *has written***
13. *has increased / is increasing*
14. *I agree that...*

Homework 3c: *Have you ever visited the Supreme Court?*

3d: *The policy failed last year*.

Session 7

1. adopted
2. had debated
3. was debating
4. *After the 18th Amendment was passed / had been passed, several ministries moved to the provinces*.
5. used to
6. did not **write**
7. drop *had*: *The policy failed in 2019*.
8. *They built the dam last year*. (or *had built* only if another later past is named)
9. *I knew the result yesterday*.
10. *Pakistan tested devices in 1998*.
11. *had failed ... had lasted* (accept *failed ... had lasted*)

Exit 4: one dated event needs past simple, not past perfect.

Session 8

1. *If the census slips again...*
2. *when the inflation peaks***

3. *Unless the provinces cooperate***
4. *As soon as the House passes the bill...*
5. was
6. *guarantees* (still in force) — accept *guaranteed* with a historical reading
7. would
8. melts
9. will have run
10. meets / is meeting

Exit 2: *said that she would come*

Session 9

Heads in brackets.

1. (quality) is
2. (each) has
3. fails
4. (secretary) was
5. (outline) was
6. (notes) were
7. revise
8. revises
9. is
10. have
11. has
12. *to examine the files, to interview witnesses and to write a report*

Exit 4: *not only corrupt but also badly designed / not only corruption but also **a failure of design*

Session 10

1. *The ordinance was struck down (by the Supreme Court).*
2. *A new framework is being drafted.*
3. *The order has not been implemented (by the provinces).*
4. *The tube wells must be metered.*
5. *The paper was leaked.*
6. Name a doer: *Economists hope inflation will fall. / Inflation may fall if the rate holds.*
7. *The education ministry should hire and inspect teachers.* (any named act)
8. *The ECP / the government delayed the census.*
9. *The cabinet decided to subsidise electricity.*
10. *The accident happened***
11. *She died of dengue.*

12. *is being passed** / *will be passed**
 13. *The poor are ignored by policy.*
 14. *The meeting took place at dawn.*
-

Session 11

1. *She said that she was drafting the rules.*
2. *He told me that he had completed the file the previous day.*
3. *The minister said that they would publish the debt.*
4. *She said that she could verify the names.*
5. *He said that water boils at 100°C.*
6. *He asked if/whether the rolls were ready.*
7. *She asked where the canal leaked.*
8. *The judge told/ordered them/him to produce the record.*
9. *The secretary told me/him not to brief the press.*
10. *He asked what the delay was.*
11. *The World Bank warned that Pakistan's water economy was at a breaking point.* (or present perfect reporting: *has warned that ... is*)

Exit 2: *He asked me where I lived.*

Session 12

1. Type 0 — correct
2. Type 1 illegal will: *If the FBR documents retailers, the deficit will shrink.*
3. *If I were you, I would rewrite the outline.*
4. Type 3: *If the dam had been completed in 1998, the 2010 flood would have been milder.*
5. Mixed — already correct
6. *The court will not sit unless the bar is on strike.*
7. *Do not file until you have the annexures.*
8. Yes, correct
- 9–10. Teacher judges form, not content.

Exit 2: *If I had known...*

Session 13

1. stop / semicolon / *and*
2. *The law exists. However, it is unenforced.* / semicolon
3. comma after *dirty*
4. smallest: drop the colon — *The state faces debt, inflation and a thin tax base.* OR complete the lead-in + colon.
5. *It is a long delay...*

6. *The 1990s were kinder...*

7. *The officers' hostel is full.*

8. question mark

9. colon

10. semicolon

11. Sample punctuation:

Although the 18th Amendment recast the federation, fiscal follow-through remains weak. The provinces demand money; they do not always build capacity. However, the answer is not to reverse devolution: it is to audit it.

(Accept equivalent legal punctuation.)

Exit 4: *The court held, "The right is not absolute."*

Session 14 — Timed drill

#	Family	Correction
1	A	<i>The quality of these reforms is poor.</i>
2	P	<i>She discussed Ø the NFC award.</i>
3	T	<i>He submitted the form yesterday.</i>
4	A+Art	<i>One of the most serious problems is extremism.</i>
5	C	<i>If the monsoon fails, wheat will be imported.</i>
6	P	<i>Despite Ø the stay, demolition began.</i>
7	A	<i>Many a candidate has failed the essay.</i>
8	T	<i>Pakistan has been facing this crisis since 2018.</i>
9	P	<i>The cabinet comprises Ø thirty ministers.</i>
10	C	<i>Wait until the House rises.</i>
11	A	<i>Neither the minister nor the aides were briefed.</i>
12	T	<i>She did not write the précis.</i>
13	Art	<i>A university degree is not employment.</i>
14	C	<i>Unless you meter the wells, the city will go dry.</i>
15	A	<i>He is one of those officers who sign every file.</i>

Dirty paragraph — planted repairs (minimum)

- *one of the main threats***
- splice after *security* → stop or *and*
- *the government*
- *for many years or has not been serious ... for many years*
- *If the state does not tax*
- *Despite Ø the speeches*

- *information ... is***
- *Many a programme has***
- *however* punctuation (stop/semicolon)
- *they collapse***
- *The quality ... is not audited*
- *Unless the cabinet publishes* (drop does not*)*

Session 15

1. *to audit accounts, publish names and impose a fine* (or three *to*-infinitives)
2. e.g. *Not only the FBR but also the courts wasted time.*
3. *Rushing to the House, the minister tabled the bill.*
4. *only in March / only the unions / only the committee*
5. *affect*
6. *She lost a loose coalition.*
7. The writer **implies**; we **infer**.
8. *fewer jobs*
9. *In my view, the cabinet should publish the unfunded teacher posts.* (any named act)
10. *Finally, we must discuss Ø education.*
11. drop *but* or *Although*
12. *I agree that information is missing.*

Transfer — model clean version (not the only one)

Pakistani youth face a tight labour market; unemployment is one of the main reasons. When young people move into the cities, they do not find jobs waiting. The state should expand technical training and remove the barriers that keep factories from hiring. If the cabinet does not listen, frustration will harden. Better public education would change that future for ordinary citizens.

Session 16

Topic sentence samples (many legal):

1. *Pakistan's water crisis is a management failure, not a rainfall mystery.*
2. *Social media is a megaphone: it enlarges both evidence and rumour.*
3. *Keeping women out of paid work is an economic policy, even when no statute says so.*
4. *Civil service reform fails when posting, not competence, decides a career.*
5. *Extremism grows where the local state is absent and the pulpit is unaccountable.*
6. *Inflation is a tax on people who cannot move their wages.*
7. Sample: *The rolls are dirty. This dirt is enough to sink an election petition and a government's claim to representation.*
(Do not drag in climate.)

8. Verbs in the model (Session 16): *is, decides, has postponed, has been explained, left, was, move, is treated, will keep, fears, cannot claim* — mixed present / present perfect / past / future on purpose.

Session 17

No single key. Use `assessments/03-final-mini-essay.md`.

Language-ready cut: fewer than 3 grammar faults per 100 words + structure ≥ 10 .

Diagnostic test (01-diagnostic.md)

- 1 F 2 R 3 S 4 S (complex) 5 F 6 R
 7 Ø Pakistan; a federation; the Constitution
 8 The information
 9 an honest; a university
 10 *One of the reasons is elite capture.*
 11 discuss Ø 12 comprises Ø 13 Despite Ø 14 prefer ... **to** 15 **for** five years 16 senior **to**
 17 did not **go** 18 I **agree** 19 **announced** last Monday 20 If the monsoon **fails** 21 **knows** 22 **became**
 23 is 24 has 25 fails 26 was 27 are
 28 *happened* 29 *told me / said to me* 30 *asked where I lived* 31 stop/semicolon + *However*; 32 *It is*

Mid-course test (02-mid-course-test.md)

- 1 F 2 R 3 sentence adverb 4 modal 5 uncountable 6 adjective as class noun 7 preposition 8 S 9 preposition 10 gerund
 11 drop *The* 12 drop *an; advice* 13 discuss Ø 14 consists **of** 15 Despite Ø 16 interested **in** 17 junior **to** 18 **since** 2019
 19 **Among** 20 drop *but* or *Although*
 21 has been 22 delivered 23 knows 24 slips 25 will have run 26 did not **write** 27 **met** 28 **has been working / has worked** since 29 would 30 adopted
 31 is 32 has 33 fails 34 was 35 were 36 revise 37 revises 38 are 39 is 40 three infinitives (see Session 9)

Paragraph: apply the 6+4 split. Three tense beats must be visible.